Mkoba User Manual

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This manual teaches you to keep your business records with Mkoba, step by step, on WhatsApp, on the web, in the Lite App and by USSD. It covers Mkoba version 2.0 as built and tested on 23 October 2026. Chapters 1–20 cover the core features; Part II (chapters 21–33) covers the features added in version 2.0.

Item	Detail
Product	Mkoba: business records on WhatsApp
Manual version	2.0
Revision date	23 October 2026
Readers	Vendors (business owners), customers, households, boda riders, lenders and the Mkoba administrator
Language of this manual	English. Mkoba itself answers in Swahili or English.

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1. Introduction

Mkoba keeps the records of a small business through ordinary WhatsApp messages. You write what you sold, bought or spent, the way you would tell a friend, and Mkoba saves it and adds it up for you.

1.1 What Mkoba does

- Saves your **sales** (mauzo), **purchases** (manunuzi) and **expenses** (matumizi) from short messages such as `nimeuza chips 5000`.

- Tells you your **profit or loss** (faida / hasara) for today, yesterday, this week, this month or all time.
- Keeps a **debt book** (madeni): who owes you, whom you owe, and payments.
- Sends you a **summary every evening** at 9 pm (Tanzania time), if you recorded something that day.
- Shows your records on a **web page** (the dashboard) on your phone's browser.
- Makes a **business statement** you can show a lender or SACCO.
- Reads **Airtel Money payment SMS** that you paste into the chat.

1.2 Problems it solves

- Records kept in a notebook get lost, wet or are hard to add up. Mkoba adds up for you.
- Many vendors do not know their real profit. Mkoba subtracts purchases and expenses from sales.
- Customers forget their debts. Mkoba remembers them and gives you a polite reminder to forward.
- Lenders ask for proof of income. Mkoba's statement shows six months of your records.

1.3 Who uses Mkoba

Role	Who it is	What they do	Chapters
Vendor	A business owner: food seller, shopkeeper, market trader	Records sales, purchases, expenses and debts; reads summaries; uses the dashboard and statement	2 to 14
Administrator	The person who runs Mkoba (the owner of the service)	Watches usage on the admin page; reviews messages Mkoba did not understand; checks the server	15

There are no other roles. Every vendor has the same features. A vendor can only ever see their own records.

1.4 What you need before you start

1. A mobile phone with **WhatsApp** installed and working.

2. Internet on that phone (mobile data or Wi-Fi).
3. The Mkoba WhatsApp number: **+255 788 001 168**.
4. For the web dashboard and statement: a web browser on your phone or computer (for example Chrome).

You do not need an app, a password or an email address.

1.5 Supported devices

- **WhatsApp chat:** any phone where WhatsApp works.
- **Web pages (dashboard, statement, privacy page):** tested in Chrome on a phone-sized screen (360 and 390 pixels wide) and on a computer screen.

1.6 Important limitations

- Mkoba understands **typed text** and, once set up, **voice notes** (chapter 30). It cannot read photos.
- Amounts are in **Tanzanian shillings (TSh)** only.
- Pasted payment SMS: only **Airtel Money Tanzania payments you make** are read today. Money you receive by SMS, and Vodacom M-Pesa or Mixx by Yas messages, are not read yet (see Appendix B).
- The web dashboard is in **Swahili only**.
- Your records are **what you type**. Mkoba does not check them against your till or bank.

1.7 How to use this manual

1. New vendor: read chapters 2 and 4 first, then 6.
2. Look up a task in the Contents and follow its numbered steps in order.
3. Text in `this style` is exactly what you type into WhatsApp. Capital or small letters do not matter.
4. Lines that start with **Mkoba replies:** show what you will see. Your amounts and names will differ.
5. Chapter 19 lists every command on one page.

1.8 A few words you will meet

Word	Meaning
Entry	One saved record, such as one sale
Mauzo	Sales: money coming in from selling
Manunuzi	Purchases: buying stock to sell
Matumizi	Expenses: other costs, such as transport or rent
Faida / Hasara	Profit / Loss: sales minus purchases and expenses
Madeni	Debts
Dashibodi	The dashboard: your records on a web page

The full list is in chapter 18 (Glossary).

2. Getting started

You start Mkoba by sending any WhatsApp message to +255 788 001 168, agreeing to how your data is used, and answering two questions. It takes about two minutes. There is nothing to install and no password. (An optional Lite App is described in chapter 32, and vendors without WhatsApp can use USSD, chapter 31.)

2.1 Save the Mkoba number (optional but helpful)

Purpose: find the Mkoba chat quickly later.

1. Open your phone's **Contacts** (or **Phone**) app.
2. Tap the button to add a new contact (often a **+** sign).
3. In the name field, type `Mkoba`.
4. In the phone number field, type `+255 788 001 168`.
5. Tap **Save**.

Result: Mkoba now appears in your contacts and in WhatsApp's contact list.

2.2 Send your first message

Before you begin: WhatsApp is working and you have internet.

1. Open **WhatsApp**.
2. Tap the new chat button (a message icon, usually at the bottom right).
3. Find **Mkoba** in the list and tap it. If you did not save the number, search for it or open a chat with +255 788 001 168.
4. In the message box at the bottom, type a greeting, for example `habari` (Swahili) or `hello` (English).
5. Tap the send button (the arrow).
6. Wait a few seconds for the reply.

Mkoba replies with a welcome and a short notice about your data, in the language you wrote in:

> Karibu Mkoba! 👋 Nitakusaidia kuweka hesabu za biashara yako kupitia WhatsApp. Ili kufanya hivyo, Mkoba itahifadhi namba yako ya simu, jina lako, na rekodi unazotuma (mauzo, manunuzi, matumizi, madeni). [...] Unaweza kuzifuta zote wakati wowote kwa kuandika FUTA DATA. Soma zaidi: https://mkoba.digital/faragha Jibu NAKUBALI kuendelea.

Important: until you agree (2.3), Mkoba saves nothing you send. If your first message was a sale such as `nimeuza 5000`, it is **not** recorded. Send it again after you agree.

2.3 Agree to how your data is used

Purpose: Mkoba needs your permission before it keeps any records.

1. Read the notice. To read the full privacy page, tap the link in the message (see 11.3).
2. Reply with `NAKUBALI` (Swahili) or `I AGREE` (English). `ndio` and `yes` also work.
3. Wait for the reply.

Mkoba replies: `Asante! Kwanza, jina lako ni nani?` (English: `Thank you! First, what's your name?`)

If you reply anything else, Mkoba repeats a shorter reminder and the link, and saves nothing. Photos and voice notes get the same reminder.

2.4 Tell Mkoba your name

1. Type your name, for example `Asha`. You can also write `naitwa Asha`, `jina langu ni Asha` or `my name is Asha`.

2. Send it.

Rules for the name: up to 4 words, no numbers. A greeting such as `habari` is not taken as a name.

Mkoba replies: `Asante Asha! Unafanya biashara gani? (mfano: chakula, duka, mboga, nguo)` and `Andika "ruka" kuruka swali hili.`

If you send something that is not a name (for example a sale with a number in it), Mkoba handles that message normally and keeps waiting for your name. Send your name when ready.

2.5 Tell Mkoba your type of business

1. Type your business in a few words, for example `chakula`, `mama lishe`, `duka la nguo` or `nauza mboga`.
2. Send it.

To skip this question, send `ruka` (English: `skip`).

Rules: up to 6 words, no numbers.

Mkoba replies: `Safi, Asha! Sasa uko tayari.` followed by the list of commands (the same list you get by sending `msaada`).

Result: you are set up. Go to chapter 4 to record your first sale.

2.6 If you already used Mkoba before October 2026

Vendors who joined before the privacy feature are asked to agree once. The next time you write, Mkoba replies with the reminder and the link. Reply `NAKUBALI`. Mkoba replies `Asante! Sasa unaweza kuendelea kutumia Mkoba.` Your old records are kept; send your message again.

2.7 Coming back later

There is nothing to log in to. Open the Mkoba chat in WhatsApp and type. Mkoba remembers your name, language and records.

2.8 Stopping

- To stop the evening summary only: send `ACHA RIPOTI` (see 6.6).
- To delete everything Mkoba holds about you: see 11.4. This cannot be undone.

- Simply not writing is also fine; nothing happens to your records.

3. Understanding Mkoba's screens

Mkoba has one place where you do the work, the WhatsApp chat, and four web pages you only read. All screenshots below are from the real application with made-up demonstration data (vendor "Asha Demo").

Screen	What it is for	How to open it	Who uses it
WhatsApp chat	Recording everything and asking for summaries	WhatsApp, chat with +255 788 001 168	Vendor
Dashboard (Dashibodi)	Seeing profit, a 14-day chart, recent records and debts	Send `dashibodi`, open the link (chapter 9)	Vendor
Business statement	Showing a lender six months of figures	Send `taarifa ya biashara`, open or share the link (chapter 10)	Vendor, lender
Privacy page	Reading how your data is used	Link in the welcome message, or https://mkoba.digital/faragha	Anyone
Admin page	Watching usage and parser quality	https://mkoba.digital/admin with the admin password	Administrator

3.1 The WhatsApp chat

The chat is an ordinary WhatsApp conversation. There are no buttons or menus. You type a message, send it, and Mkoba answers within a few seconds.

- **Your messages** appear on the right.
- **Mkoba's replies** appear on the left. A reply that starts with `Sawa!` (Done!) means something was saved or changed.
- A reply that ends with `Jibu NDIO au HAPANA` (Reply YES or NO) means Mkoba is waiting for you before saving (chapter 5).
- A reply that starts with `Samahani` (Sorry) means Mkoba did not understand or could not do what you asked; it tells you what to send instead.

To see every command, send `msaada` (English: `help`).

3.2 The dashboard

Dashibodi ya Asha Demo

Toka

Leo | Wiki hii | Mwezi huu

Hasara leo

TSh 54,000

Mauzo	TSh 0
Manunuzi	TSh 52,000
Matumizi	TSh 2,000

Siku 14 zilizopita



09/10 Leo

Kijani ni faida, nyekundu ni hasara.

Rekodi za karibuni

Matumizi ya nauli 22/10 08:00	−TSh 2,000
Manunuzi ya mchele (25 kg) 22/10 07:00	−TSh 52,000
Mauzo ya soda (11) 21/10 13:00	+TSh 6,700
Mauzo ya chips 21/10 12:00	+TSh 19,300
Matumizi ya nauli 21/10 08:00	−TSh 2,000
Manunuzi ya mafuta (2 l) 21/10 07:00	−TSh 9,000
Mauzo ya soda (12) [illegible]	+TSh 7,400

20/10 13:00

Mauzo ya chips 20/10 12:00	+TSh 20,600
Matumizi ya nauli 20/10 08:00	−TSh 2,000
Manunuzi ya mafuta (2 l) 20/10 07:00	−TSh 9,000
Malipo kutoka kwa Juma 19/10 14:50	TSh 2,000
Mauzo ya soda (14) 18/10 13:00	+TSh 8,800

Madeni

Unaowadai

Mama Rose	TSh 7,500
Juma	TSh 3,000



From top to bottom:

1. **Title** (`Dashibodi ya Asha Demo`) and **Toka** (log out) at the top right.
2. **Period buttons:** `Leo` (today), `Wiki hii` (this week), `Mwezi huu` (this month). The one with a dark border is selected.
3. **Result:** `Faida` (profit) in green or `Hasara` (loss) in red, as one big number for the chosen period.
4. **Breakdown:** Mauzo (sales) in green, Manunuzi (purchases) and Matumizi (expenses) in red.
5. **Siku 14 zilizopita** (last 14 days): one bar per day. A green bar above the line is a day of profit; a red bar below is a day of loss. No bar means nothing recorded.
6. **Rekodi za karibuni** (recent records): the 12 newest entries, newest first, with date and time. Green `+` amounts are sales, red `−` amounts are purchases and expenses, dark amounts without a sign are debt entries.
7. **Madeni** (debts): `Unaowadai` (people who owe you) and `Wanaokudai` (people you owe), with balances.
8. **Faragha na taarifa zako:** link to the privacy page.

The dashboard only shows information. To change records, use WhatsApp (chapter 5) or the Lite App (chapter 32), which the dashboard links to.

3.3 The business statement



From Mkoba — Soma kwa Kiswahili

Business statement: Asha Demo

Business: **chakula**
Phone: **+255 70x xxx 123**
Using Mkoba since: **30/04/2026**
Period: **May 2026 – October 2026**

Amounts in TSh. Days = days with records.

Month	Sales	Costs	Profit	Days
Oct 2026	528,000	327,000	201,000	18
Sep 2026	774,000	447,000	327,000	25
Aug 2026	824,000	415,000	409,000	26
Jul 2026	823,000	458,000	365,000	26
Jun 2026	777,000	447,000	330,000	25
May 2026	816,000	415,000	401,000	26
Total	4,542,000	2,509,000	2,033,000	146

Average monthly sales	TSh 757,000
Average monthly profit	TSh 338,833
Days with records	146 / 175 (83%)
Owed to the business by customers	TSh 10,500
Owed by the business	TSh 8,000
Records from mobile-money SMS	3%

These figures come from records the business owner entered in Mkoba on WhatsApp. Mkoba has not verified them. Records imported from mobile-money SMS were taken directly from the provider's messages.

Reference: **5DA2AF4884**
Generated: **22/10/2026**
Link valid until: **21/11/2026**

The statement shows your name, business, a partly hidden phone number, when you started using Mkoba, and a table of the last six months: sales, costs, profit and days with records. Under it are averages, debts and how many records came from mobile-money SMS. The note at the bottom says these are your own records, not checked by Mkoba. Details are in chapter 10.

3.4 The privacy page

A plain page explaining what Mkoba stores, why, who sees it, how long it is kept and your choices. It has a Swahili version (/faragha) and an English version (/privacy), linked to each other at the top. Details are in 11.3.

3.5 The admin page

For the administrator only. Described in chapter 15.

4. Recording sales, purchases and expenses

This is the main job of Mkoba. You write what happened in your own words, and Mkoba saves it as one of three kinds of record:

Kind	Swahili	Meaning	Counts as
Sale	mauzo	Money that came in from selling	Money in
Purchase	manunuzi	Stock you bought to sell or to cook with	Money out
Expense	matumizi	Running costs: rent, electricity, transport, wages	Money out

Before you start: you must have replied `NAKUBALI` to the consent message (chapter 2). Until you do, Mkoba saves nothing.

4.1 Record one sale

1. Open the Mkoba chat in WhatsApp.
2. Type the word for what you did, what you sold, and the money. Example: `nimeuza chips 5000`
3. Press send.
4. Wait for the reply. It will be: `Sawa! Nimeongeza mauzo ya chips TSh 5,000. Asante!`

The word `Sawa!` means it is saved. Nothing else is needed.

4.2 Record a purchase or an expense

The steps are the same; only the first word changes.

- Purchase: `nimenunua mchele kilo 10 kwa 25,000` → saved as manunuzi of mchele, 10 kg, TSh 25,000.
- Expense: `nimelipa umeme 15k` → saved as matumizi of umeme, TSh 15,000.

4.3 The words Mkoba recognises

Mkoba decides the kind of record from the action word. You can use any of these forms (and short typing mistakes such as `nmeuza` or `nimenunu` are usually corrected for you):

Kind	Swahili words	English words
Sale	nimeuza, niliuza, tumeuza, tuliuza, nimeuzia, nauza, mauzo, nimepokea, nimepata, nimelipwa, nimetumiwa	sold, sale, sales, sell
Purchase	nimenunua, nilinunua, tumenunua, nanunua, manunuzi, ununuzi, nimeuziwa	bought, buy, purchase, purchased
Expense	nimelipa, nililipa, tumelipa, nimetumia, nilitumia, gharama, matumizi	paid, spent, expense, expenses

Important: `nimelipwa` (I was paid) and `nimetumiwa` (I was sent money) are saved as **sales**, because money came in. `nimeuziwa` (I was sold) is saved as a **purchase**.

4.4 How to write the amount

All of these mean TSh 5,000:

- Digits: `5000`, `5,000`, `5.000`
- With a currency word: `Tsh 5000`, `5000/=`, `sh 5000`
- Thousands with k: `5k`. Millions with m: `2m` = TSh 2,000,000
- Swahili words: `elfu tano`. Other examples: `elfu kumi na tano` = 15,000, `elfu mbili mia tano` = 2,500, `mia saba hamsini` = 750
- Street words: `buku tano`, `ngiri tano`, `thao tano` (buku, ngiri and thao each mean 1,000); `jero mbili` = 1,000 (jero means 500)

Mkoba works only in Tanzanian shillings. There is no other currency.

4.5 Quantities and units

You can add how much you bought or sold. Mkoba keeps it next to the record; it is not added to the money.

- Kilograms: `kilo 10`, `10 kg`, `10kg`
- Litres: `lita 5`, `5 l`
- Grams: `gramu 500`
- Pieces: `vipande 3`, `3 pcs`

Example: `nimenunua mafuta lita 5 kwa 20000` is saved as a purchase of mafuta (5 l), TSh 20,000.

4.6 Several records in one message

You can send many records at once, either one per line or one after another.

```
nimeuza chips 5000
nimenunua mafuta 3000
```

or on one line: `nimeuza chips 5000 nimenunua mafuta 3000`

Mkoba splits the message at each action word and replies with a list:

```
Sawa! Nimeongeza:
- Mauzo ya chips TSh 5,000
- Manunuzi ya mafuta TSh 3,000
Asante!
```

If any one part is not understood, **nothing** from that message is saved, and Mkoba tells you which part to fix. Send the whole message again, corrected.

4.7 Price memory: selling by count

When you write a small number (below 100) without the word Tsh, Mkoba treats it as a **count of items**, not money, because nothing sells for less than TSh 100.

If you have sold this item before, Mkoba uses your last price for it, works out the total, and asks you to confirm:

1. You have earlier saved `nimeuza soda 3 kwa 1800` (TSh 600 each).
2. Now you send `nimeuza soda 10`.

3. Mkoba replies with what it understood, the line `(soda: TSh 600 kila moja, kama rekodi yako ya mwisho)` and `Ni sahihi? Jibu NDIO au HAPANA.`
4. Reply `NDIO` to save TSh 6,000, or `HAPANA` to cancel (see chapter 5).

If Mkoba has no earlier price for the item, it asks:

`maandazi 5 kwa bei gani? Andika kwa mfano: nimeuza maandazi 5 kwa 3000`

Send the message again with the total money, as shown.

Price memory works for sales and purchases, using only your own confirmed records.

4.8 When Mkoba is unsure

Mkoba scores how sure it is about each message:

- **Sure:** saved at once; reply starts with `Sawa!`
- **Fairly sure:** not counted yet; Mkoba shows what it understood and asks `NDIO` or `HAPANA` (chapter 5). This happens, for example, with two plain numbers (`nimeuza 3000 4000`) or a price calculated from memory.
- **Not sure:** nothing saved; Mkoba replies `Samahani, sikuelewa vizuri. Ulitumia/uliuza kiasi gani, TSh ngapi?` Send the message again with an action word and an amount.

Common reasons for "not sure":

- No action word: `chips 5000`
- No amount: `nimeuza chips`

4.9 Voice notes, photos and other messages

Voice notes are turned into text and handled like a typed message, once the administrator has set this up (chapter 30); records from voice always wait for `NDIO`. Until then, a voice note gets a reply asking you to type. **Photos, stickers, videos and documents** are not read: nothing is saved and Mkoba asks you to type the record. A shared **location** is saved and used to find your nearest bulk-buy group (chapter 24) and to work out delivery fees (chapter 28).

4.10 Dates and times

Every record gets the date and time Mkoba **received** your message (Tanzania time). You cannot set a different date. Words like `jana` (yesterday) in a message are ignored, so record each day's business on that day.

5. Confirming, correcting and deleting records

5.1 Answering a YES/NO question

When Mkoba is fairly sure but not certain, it shows what it understood and waits:

```
Nimeelewa hivi:
- Mauzo ya soda (10) TSh 6,000
(soda: TSh 600 kila moja, kama rekodi yako ya mwisho)
Ni sahihi? Jibu NDIO au HAPANA.
```

The record is **not counted** in any summary until you answer.

To save it:

1. Reply with one of: `NDIO`, `ndiyo`, `sawa`, `ok`, `sahihi`, `yes`, `y`.
2. Mkoba replies `Sawa! Nimeongeza ...` and the record now counts.

To cancel it:

1. Reply with one of: `HAPANA`, `sio`, `si sahihi`, `no`, `n`.
2. Mkoba replies: `Sawa, sijahifadhi. Tafadhali tuma tena kwa usahihi, mfano: nimenunua mchele 25000`
3. Send the record again, written more clearly.

Rules to know:

- The question stays open for **1 hour**. After that, `NDIO` no longer saves it; send the record again.
- If you send a **new record** instead of answering, the unanswered one is dropped and only the new one is handled.
- Your answer must be the only thing in the message. `ndio nimeuza 5000` is not read as an answer.

5.2 Delete your last record (futa)

Use this when you saved something by mistake.

1. Send `futa` (also accepted: `futa ya mwisho`, `futa hiyo`, `ondoa`, `undo`, `delete`).
2. Mkoba deletes the **last saved message's records** and replies, for example: `Nimefuta mauzo ya chips TSh 5,000.`

Things to know:

- If your last message had several records, `futa` deletes **all of them** and lists them.
- Send `futa` again to delete the message before that, one message at a time.
- It also works for the last debt record (chapter 7).
- Only saved records are affected. A record waiting for NDIO/HAPANA is cancelled with `HAPANA`, not `futa`.
- If there is nothing to delete, Mkoba replies `Hakuna rekodi ya kubadilisha.`
- A deleted record cannot be brought back. Record it again if needed.

5.3 Change the amount of your last record (rekebisha)

Use this when the kind and item were right but the money was wrong.

1. Send `rekebisha` followed by the correct amount, for example `rekebisha 6500` (also accepted: `badilisha`, `sahihisha`, `correct`, `edit`). Any amount format from 4.4 works, such as `rekebisha elfu sita`.
2. Mkoba replies, for example: `Nimerekebisha mauzo ya chips: TSh 6,000 → TSh 6,500.`

Things to know:

- Only the **amount** changes. To change the kind (sale/purchase/expense) or the item, use `futa` and send the record again.
- If you forget the amount, Mkoba replies `Andika kiasi kipya, mfano: rekebisha 6000`.
- If your last message had several records, `rekebisha` cannot choose one. Mkoba replies `Ujumbe wako wa mwisho ulikuwa na rekodi 2. Andika "futa" kisha utume tena kwa usahihi.` Follow that advice.
- Only the most recent message can be corrected. Older records cannot be edited.

6. Summaries and evening reports

6.1 Ask for a summary

1. Send one of the words in the table. The word must be the whole message.
2. Mkoba replies with the totals for that period.

Send	Period	Also accepted
`leo`	Today (from midnight)	today, muhtasari, ripoti, ripoti ya leo, hesabu ya leo
`jana`	Yesterday	yesterday, ripoti ya jana
`wiki`	This week, from Monday	wiki hii, week, this week, ripoti ya wiki
`mwezi`	This month, from the 1st	mwezi huu, month, this month, ripoti ya mwezi
`salio`	Everything since you started	balance, jumla, total

All periods use Tanzania time.

6.2 Reading a summary

Example reply to `leo`:

```
📊 Muhtasari wa leo:
Mauzo: TSh 38,000 (5)
Manunuzi: TSh 20,000 (2)
Matumizi: TSh 3,000 (1)
Faida: TSh 15,000

Inayouza zaidi: chips (TSh 25,000)
Gharama kubwa zaidi: mchele (TSh 20,000)
Jana: faida TSh 9,000
```

- The number in brackets after each total is **how many records** it adds up.
- **Faida** (profit) = Mauzo − Manunuzi − Matumizi. If the result is below zero, the line says **Hasara** (loss) with the amount.
- **Inayouza zaidi:** the item with the most sales money in the period.
- **Gharama kubwa zaidi:** the item with the most purchase and expense money in the period.

- **Last line:** the result of the period before (Jana for leo, Juzi for jana, Wiki iliyopita for wiki, Mwezi uliopita for mwezi), so you can compare.

The extra lines appear only when there is something to show: items need a name in your records, and the comparison needs records in the earlier period. `salio` shows totals only.

Only confirmed sales, purchases and expenses count. Debts (chapter 7) and records waiting for NDIO are **not** in these totals.

If there is nothing in the period, Mkoba replies `Hakuna rekodi za leo bado.` (or the period you asked).

6.3 The evening report

Every evening at **21:00 Tanzania time** (saa 3 usiku), Mkoba sends you a summary automatically, if all of these are true:

- You agreed to the data terms (NAKUBALI).
- Evening reports are on for you (they are on unless you turned them off).
- You recorded something in the period.

Monday to Saturday the report covers **today**. On **Sunday** it covers **the whole week**, and also lists up to five people who owe you, with how many days the debt has been open.

What the report looks like depends on when you last wrote to Mkoba:

- **You wrote within the last 23 hours:** the full summary from 6.2, starting `Habari Asha!` and ending `Kusitisha ripoti hizi, andika ACHA RIPOTI.` It is in your chosen language.
- **You have not written for 23 hours or more:** WhatsApp rules allow only an approved message format. You get a shorter Swahili report with your name, the period, sales, purchases, expenses and profit or loss, without the extra lines.

You get at most one report per evening.

6.4 Turn evening reports off or on

To stop them:

1. Send `ACHA RIPOTI` (also: `sitisha ripoti`, `zima ripoti`, `stop reports`).
2. Mkoba replies: `Sawa, nimesitisha ripoti za jioni. Kuwasha tena, andika ANZA RIPOTI.`

To start them again:

1. Send `ANZA RIPOTI` (also: `washa ripoti`, `start reports`).
2. Mkoba replies: `Sawa! Utapokea muhtasari kila jioni saa 3 usiku.`

You cannot change the time of the report.

7. Debts (madeni)

Mkoba keeps a running balance with each person: what customers owe you (credit you gave) and what you owe suppliers. Debts are kept **separate** from sales and costs, so they never change your profit.

7.1 The four debt messages

What happened	Write it like this	Mkoba's reply
A customer took goods on credit (they owe you)	`namdai Juma 5000`, `Juma anadaiwa 5000`, `nimemkopesha Juma 5000`, `Juma amekopa 5000`	`Sawa! Juma anadaiwa TSh 5,000.` then the balance
You took goods or money on credit (you owe them)	`Juma ananidai 5000`, `nadaiwa na Juma 5000`, `nimekopa kwa Juma 5000`	`Sawa! Unadaiwa na Juma TSh 5,000.` then the balance
They paid you back	`Juma amelipa 2000`, `Juma amenilipa 2000`, `Juma amerudisha 2000`	`Sawa! Juma amelipa TSh 2,000.` then the balance
You paid them back	`nimemlipa Juma 2000`, `nimelipa deni la Juma 2000`, `nimemrudishia Juma 2000`	`Sawa! Umemlipa Juma TSh 2,000.` then the balance

English also works: `lent Juma 5000`, `Juma owes me 5000`, `I owe Juma 5000`, `Juma paid 2000`.

The second line of every reply is the new balance, for example `Salio: Juma anadaiwa TSh 3,000.` When the balance reaches zero it says `Salio: Hakuna deni kati yako na Juma.`

7.2 Step by step: a customer buys on credit, then pays

1. Mama Neema takes food worth TSh 4,000 and will pay later. Send: `Mama Neema anadaiwa 4000`
2. Mkoba replies: `Sawa! Mama Neema anadaiwa TSh 4,000.` and `Salio: Mama Neema anadaiwa TSh 4,000.`
3. Two days later she pays TSh 1,500. Send: `Mama Neema amelipa 1500`
4. Mkoba replies with the new balance: TSh 2,500.

Note: the food itself is not a sale until it is paid. If you also want the money in your sales totals, record the sale when she pays, for example `nimeuza chakula 1500`.

7.3 Names

- A name is **one word** (`Juma`), or one word after a title: mama, baba, bi, bw, bwana, kaka, dada, mzee, ndugu, shangazi, mjomba, mr, mrs (`Mama Neema`, `Kaka Ali`).
- Two-word names without a title do **not** work as expected: `Juma Ali anadaiwa 4000` is saved under **Ali** only. Use one word or a title.
- Capital letters do not matter: `juma` and `Juma` are the same person.
- Use the **same name every time** for the same person, or Mkoba will treat them as two people.

7.4 Be careful with the word for paying

- `nimemlipa Juma 2000` (I paid **him**) is a **debt repayment**.
- `nimelipa Juma 2000` (without the **m**) is read as an ordinary **expense** called "juma".

If you forget the amount, Mkoba asks: `Kiasi gani? Mfano: Juma amelipa 5000`. Send the whole message again with the amount.

7.5 See your debts

Everyone: send `madeni` (or `deni`, `debts`). Example reply:

```
📒 Madeni:
Unaowadai:
- Juma TSh 3,000 (siku 12)
Wanaokudai:
- Mama Neema TSh 2,500 (siku 2)
```

- **Unaowadai** = people who owe you. **Wanaokudai** = people you owe.
- `(siku 12)` = days since the last new credit with that person.
- People with a zero balance are not listed. If nobody owes anything: `Hakuna madeni.`

One person: send `deni Juma` (also `deni la Juma`, `debt Juma`).

- If you owe them, or the balance is zero, you get one line.
- If they owe you, you get **two messages**. The first explains, the second is a ready reminder to forward:

```
Habari Juma, hii ni kumbukumbu ya deni lako kwa Asha: TSh 3,000 (tangu
10/10/2026). Asante!
```

7.6 Send a debt reminder to a customer

1. Send `deni Juma`.
2. Press and hold the second message (the one starting `Habari Juma`).
3. Tap **Sambaza** (Forward).
4. Choose Juma's chat in your WhatsApp contacts and send.

Mkoba never messages your customers itself; you decide whether to forward. The reminder shows your name only if you gave Mkoba a name during sign-up.

7.7 Fix a debt mistake

If the debt record was your last record, send `futa` to delete it (5.2) or `rekebisha 4000` to change the amount (5.3). Otherwise, record the opposite entry to balance it out.

8. Mobile-money SMS

Instead of typing a payment, you can copy the confirmation SMS your mobile-money provider sent you and paste it into the Mkoba chat. Mkoba reads the amount, who was paid and the fee.

What is supported today: money **leaving** your **Airtel Money Tanzania** account (paying a till or Lipa number, paying a merchant, buying a bundle, sending money to a person). **Money you receive** is not read yet, and other providers (M-Pesa, Tigo Pesa, HaloPesa and others) are not supported. For those, type the record as in chapter 4.

8.1 Paste an SMS

1. Open your phone's **Messages** app and find the Airtel Money confirmation SMS.
2. Press and hold the message, then choose **Copy**.
3. Open the Mkoba chat in WhatsApp.
4. Press and hold the typing box, choose **Paste**, and send. Do not change the text.
5. Read Mkoba's reply and answer it, as described below.

8.2 Paying a till, merchant or bundle

Mkoba shows what it will save and asks you to confirm:

```
Nimeelewa hivi:
- Manunuzi ya Duka La Mfano TSh 10,000
- Matumizi ya ada Airtel Money TSh 1,000
Ni sahihi? Jibu NDIO au HAPANA.
```

- Till, Lipa and merchant payments are saved as **purchases** (manunuzi).
- Bundle payments are saved as **expenses** (matumizi).
- The provider's fee, if the SMS shows one, is a separate **expense** called "ada Airtel Money".

Reply `NDIO` to save or `HAPANA` to cancel, within 1 hour (see 5.1).

8.3 Sending money to a person

Mkoba cannot know why you sent money to a person, so it asks:

```
Umetuma TSh 1,000 kwa Mfano Jina (ada TSh 45). Hii ni nini?
1 - Manunuzi (bidhaa za biashara)
2 - Matumizi ya biashara
3 - Si ya biashara (binafsi)
Jibu 1, 2 au 3.
```

1. Reply `1` if it paid for stock, `2` if it was a business cost, or `3` if it was personal (family, yourself).
2. For 1 or 2, Mkoba replies `Sawa! Nimeongeza: ...` with the amount and the fee (the fee is always an expense).
3. For 3, Mkoba replies `Sawa, sijauweka kwenye hesabu za biashara.` and nothing is saved.

You can also reply with the words `manunuzi`, `matumizi` or `binafsi`. If you reply `NDIO`, Mkoba asks again for 1, 2 or 3. The question stays open for 1 hour.

8.4 Messages Mkoba recognises but does not save

SMS type	Mkoba replies (meaning)
Cash deposit at an agent, or moving money to your Airtel Money Global Pay card	It is your own money moving, not a sale or cost. Not saved.
A bank-card payment message	It is a bank card, not mobile money. Not saved.
An M-Pesa Kenya message in Ksh	Mkoba works in TSh only. Not saved.

8.5 Pasting the same SMS twice

Each Airtel SMS has a transaction number (TID). If you paste an SMS that is already saved, Mkoba replies `Muamala huu (TID...) tayari umeshawekwa kwenye hesabu.` and saves nothing again.

8.6 If Mkoba does not recognise the SMS

The text is then read like a normal typed message. Usually Mkoba replies `Samahani, sikuelewa vizuri...`, but if the SMS contains a word such as "paid" and a number, it may be misread as an ordinary record. Always read the reply: if it is wrong, answer `HAPANA` (if asked) or send `futa` (if saved), then type the record yourself, for example `nimenunua mafuta 10000`.

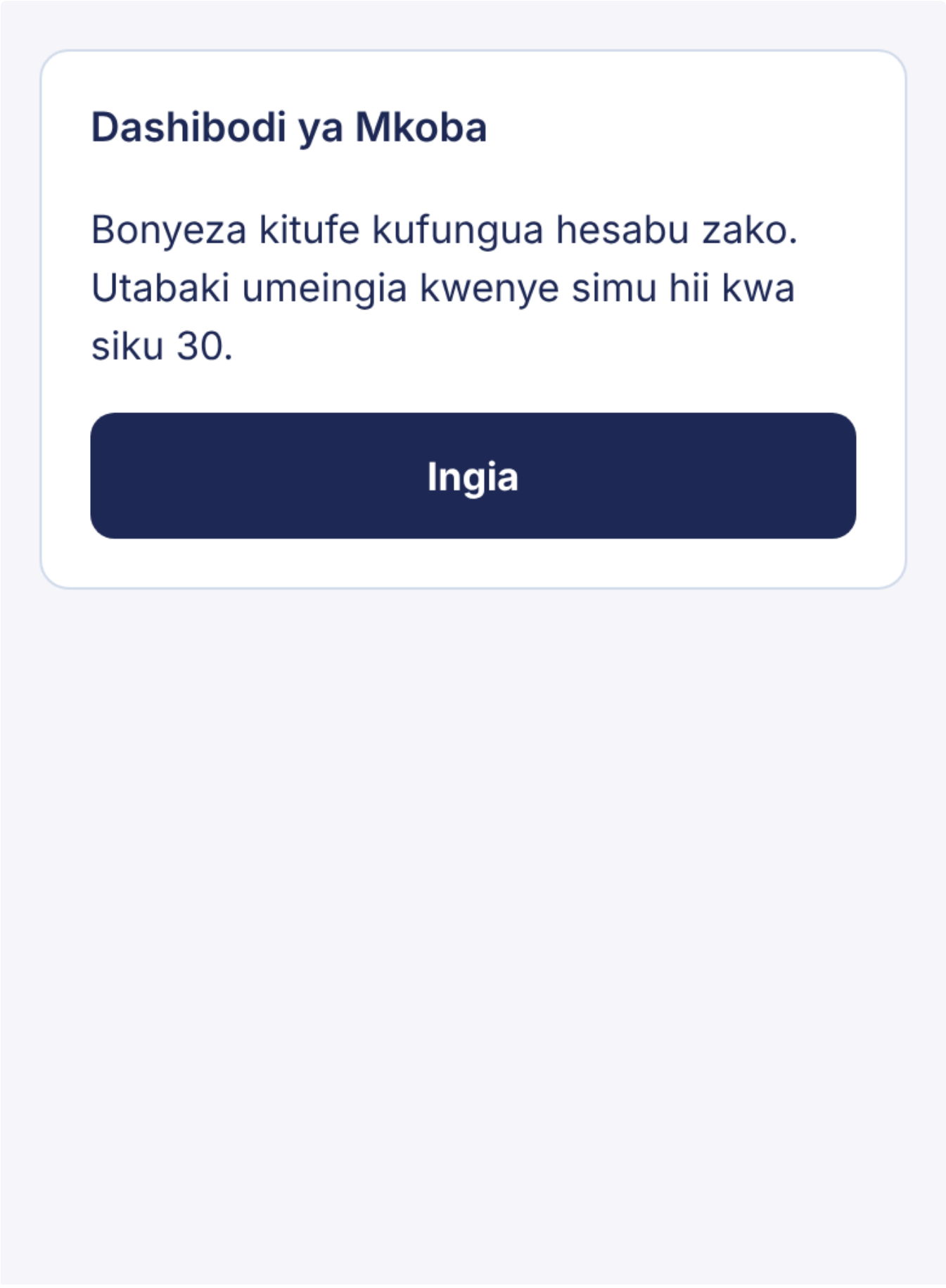
9. The web dashboard

The dashboard shows your numbers on a web page: profit for today, this week or this month, a 14-day chart, your latest records and your debts. It only displays information; all changes are made in WhatsApp. The dashboard is in Swahili only.

9.1 Open the dashboard for the first time

1. In the Mkoba chat, send `dashibodi` (also: `dashboard`, `mtandaoni`, `link ya dashibodi`).

2. Mkoba replies: `Fungua dashibodi yako hapa (kiungo kinafanya kazi kwa dakika 15, mara moja tu):` followed by a link starting `https://mkoba.digital/d/login?t=`.
3. Tap the link. Your phone's browser opens this page:


Dashibodi ya Mkoba
Bonyeza kitufe kufungua hesabu zako. Utabaki umeingia kwenye simu hii kwa siku 30.
Ingia

4. Tap the green **Ingia** (Log in) button.
5. Your dashboard opens (see 3.2 for every part of the page).

Rules for the link:

- It works for **15 minutes** and **one time only**.
- Opening the link does not log you in by itself; you must tap **Ingia**. This stops link-preview tools from using it up.
- Do not forward the link: whoever taps Ingia first sees your records.

9.2 Stay logged in

After you tap Ingia, the browser on that phone stays logged in for **30 days**. To come back, open the same browser and go to `https://mkoba.digital/d`. You do not need a new link until the 30 days are over or you log out.

If you are not logged in, the page looks like this. Send `dashibodi` in WhatsApp to get a new link.

Dashibodi ya Mkoba

Tuma **dashibodi** kwenye WhatsApp ya Mkoba. Utapokea kiungo cha kuingia.

9.3 Change the period

Tap **Leo** (today), **Wiki hii** (this week, from Monday) or **Mwezi huu** (this month). The big number and the breakdown change to that period. The 14-day chart, recent records and debts stay the same.

Dashibodi ya Asha Demo

Toka

Leo | Wiki hii | **Mwezi huu**

Faida mwezi huu

TSh 201,000

Mauzo	TSh 528,000
Manunuzi	TSh 291,000
Matumizi	TSh 36,000

Siku 14 zilizopita





9.4 Log out

Do this on a shared or borrowed phone.

1. Tap **Toka** at the top right of the dashboard.
2. The page shows **Umetoka** (You have logged out).

Umetoka

Tuma **dashibodi** kwenye WhatsApp kuingia tena.

9.5 When the link does not work

If the link is older than 15 minutes or was already used, you see:

Kiungo hiki hakifanyi kazi tena

Kimeisha muda au kimeshatumika. Tuma **dashibodi** kwenye WhatsApp ya Mkoba upate kiungo kipya.

Send `dashibodi` again in WhatsApp and use the new link straight away.

9.6 What the dashboard counts

The same rules as WhatsApp summaries (6.2): only confirmed sales, purchases and expenses count towards profit. Records waiting for NDIO are not shown. Debt records appear in **Rekodi za karibuni** without a + or − sign, because they are not sales or costs.

10. The business statement for lenders

A lender, bank or SACCO usually wants to see how your business has done before giving a loan. Mkoba can make a web page with your last six months of figures and give you a private link to share.

10.1 Create a statement

1. In the Mkoba chat, send `taarifa ya biashara` (also: `ripoti ya biashara`, `taarifa ya mkopo`, `ripoti ya mkopo`, `statement`, `business statement`, `loan statement`).
2. Mkoba replies:

```
Taarifa yako ya biashara iko tayari (miezi 6 iliyopita). Unaweza kumtumia
mkopeshaji au SACCO kiungo hiki; kinafanya kazi siku 30:
https://mkoba.digital/s/...
Kukifunga mapema, andika FUNGA TAARIFA.
```

3. Tap the link to check the page yourself before sharing it.

10.2 Share it with a lender

Choose one way:

- **WhatsApp:** press and hold Mkoba's message with the link, tap **Sambaza** (Forward), and choose the lender's chat. Or copy only the link and paste it into a message.
- **Email or SMS:** press and hold the link, choose **Copy**, and paste it into your email or SMS to the lender.
- **On paper:** open the link on a computer and use the browser's **Print** command (Ctrl+P on Windows, Cmd+P on Mac). Choose a printer, or "Save as PDF" to get a file.

The lender does not need WhatsApp or a Mkoba account to open the link.

10.3 What the lender sees

Kutoka Mkoba

Read in English

Taarifa ya biashara: Asha Demo

Biashara

chakula

Simu

+255 70x xxx 123

Anatumia Mkoba tangu

30/04/2026

Kipindi

Mei 2026 – Oktoba 2026

Kiasi ni kwa TSh. Siku = siku zenye rekodi.

Mwezi	Mauzo	Gharama	Faida	Siku
Okt 2026	528,000	327,000	201,000	18
Sep 2026	774,000	447,000	327,000	25
Ago 2026	824,000	415,000	409,000	26
Jul 2026	823,000	458,000	365,000	26

Jun 2026	777,000	447,000	330,000	25
Mei 2026	816,000	415,000	401,000	26
Jumla	**4,542,000**	**2,509,000**	**2,033,000**	**146**

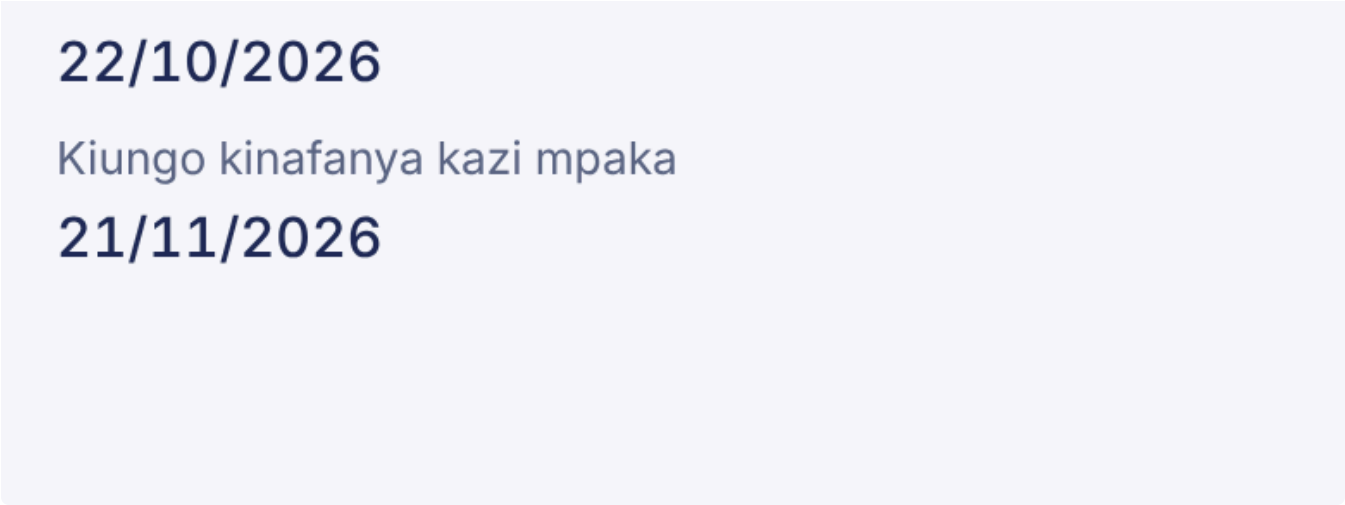
Wastani wa mauzo kwa mwezi	TSh 757,000
Wastani wa faida kwa mwezi	TSh 338,833
Siku zenye rekodi	146 / 175 (83%)
Wateja wanaodaiwa (anawadai)	TSh 10,500
Madeni yake (anadaiwa)	TSh 8,000
Rekodi kutoka SMS za pesa ya simu	3%

Taarifa hii inatokana na rekodi alizoweka mfanyabiashara mwenyewe kwenye Mkoba kupitia WhatsApp. Mkoba haijazihakiki. Rekodi zilizotoka kwenye SMS za pesa ya simu zimetoka moja kwa moja kwenye ujumbe wa mtoa huduma.

Namba ya kumbukumbu

5DA2AF4884

Imetolewa



The page shows, from top to bottom:

1. **Title** with your name (if you gave one during sign-up), and a link to switch language: **Read in English / Soma kwa Kiswahili**. It opens in your chosen language.
2. **Biashara** (business type, if you gave one), **Simu** (your phone number with the middle digits hidden), **Anatumia Mkoba tangu** (date of your first record) and **Kipindi** (the six months covered).
3. **The table:** one row per month, newest first, with Mauzo (sales), Gharama (purchases plus expenses), Faida (profit; a loss has a minus sign and is red) and Siku (number of days with records). Amounts are in TSh. The last row is the total.
4. **Averages and other facts:** average monthly sales and profit (counted over months that have records), days with records out of all days in the period, how much customers owe you, how much you owe, and the share of records that came from mobile-money SMS.
5. **A note** saying that the figures are the owner's own records and that Mkoba has not verified them.
6. **Namba ya kumbukumbu** (reference number), the date it was generated, and the date the link stops working.

The statement shows **totals only**. Individual records, customer names and your messages are never shown.

10.4 How long the link works, and closing it

- A link works for **30 days**, then shows a "closed" page.
- Making a **new** statement closes all your **older** statement links. Only the newest link works.

- To close all your links early (for example after the loan decision), send `FUNGA TAARIFA` (also: `funga taarifa ya biashara`, `close statement`, `revoke statement`). Mkoba replies: `Sawa, viungo vyote vya taarifa yako ya biashara vimefungwa.`

A closed or expired link shows this page:

Taarifa ya biashara

Kiungo hiki kimeisha muda au kimefungwa na mwenye biashara.

10.5 Make your statement stronger

Lenders look for regular, complete records. Record every day, record costs as well as sales, and correct mistakes straight away (chapter 5). Months before you started using Mkoba show zeros.

11. Language, privacy and your data

11.1 Choose your language

Mkoba replies in **Swahili** or **English**. Swahili is the default.

Switch on purpose:

1. Send `english` (also `kiingereza`, `in english`). Mkoba replies: `OK, I'll reply in English. For Swahili, send KISWAHILI.`

2. To go back, send `kiswahili` (also `swahili`, `kwa kiswahili`). Mkoba replies: `Sawa, nitajibu kwa Kiswahili. Kwa Kiingereza, tuma ENGLISH.`

Automatic switch: if a message is clearly written in only one language (for example `sold chips 5000`), Mkoba switches to that language and remembers it. Mixed messages do not change the language. Pasted mobile-money SMS never change it.

What follows your language: all WhatsApp replies, the full evening report, the privacy link and the language the statement opens in. What is always Swahili: the web dashboard and the short evening report sent after 23 hours of silence (6.3).

11.2 Agreeing to the data terms

Your first message to Mkoba gets a welcome that explains what Mkoba stores, with a link to the privacy page, and ends `Jibu NAKUBALI kuendelea.`

- Reply `NAKUBALI` (also `ninakubali`, `kubali`, `ndio`, `ndiyo`, `I agree`, `agree`, `accept`, `yes`).
- Until you agree, Mkoba records nothing, sends no evening reports, and answers every message with a reminder to agree.
- `FUTA DATA` works even before you agree.

11.3 The privacy page

Open `https://mkoba.digital/faragha` (Swahili) or `https://mkoba.digital/privacy` (English). Each has a link to the other at the top.

Mkoba: jinsi taarifa zako zinavyotumika

Read in English

Tunachohifadhi

Namba yako ya WhatsApp, jina na aina ya biashara unayotupa, ujumbe unaotuma kwa Mkoba, na rekodi zinazotokana nao: mauzo, manunuzi, matumizi, madeni (pamoja na majina ya watu kwenye rekodi za madeni), na ujumbe wa pesa ya simu unaobandika.

Kwa nini

Ili kuweka hesabu za biashara yako na kukutumia muhtasari wako tu. Tunaomba ukubali kabla ya kuhifadhi chochote.

Nani anaziona

Wewe, kupitia WhatsApp na dashibodi yako. Timu ya Mkoba, kwa ajili ya kuendesha

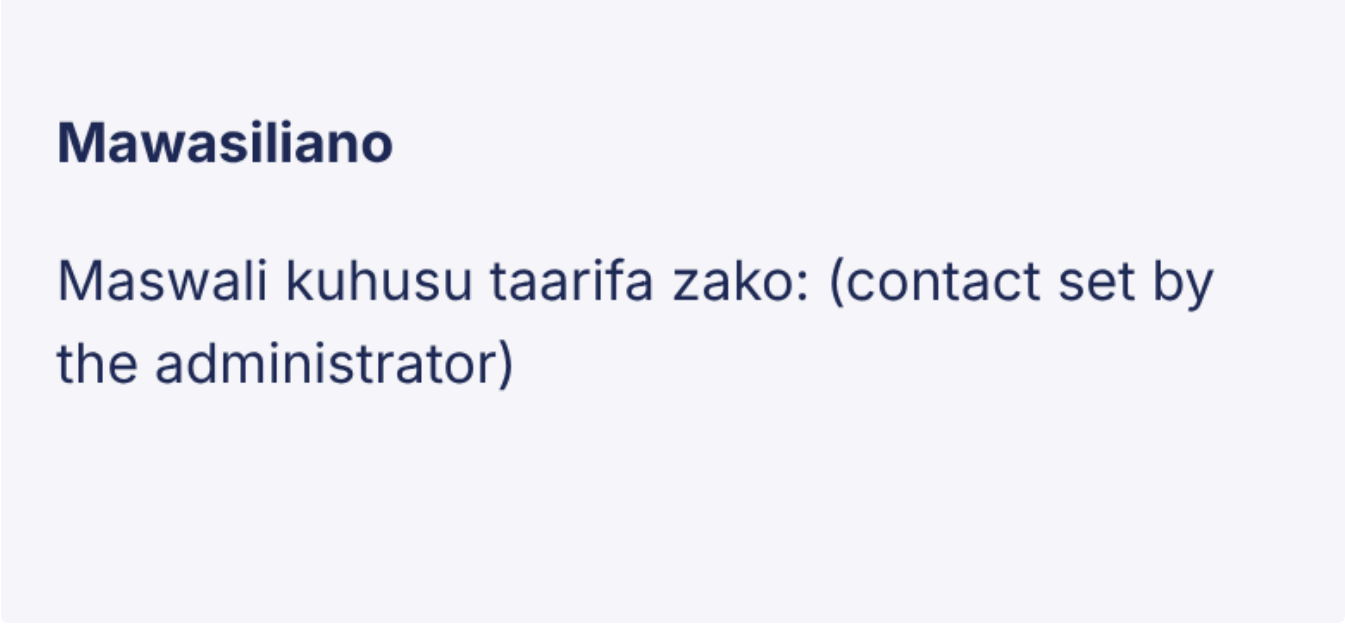
Timu ya Mkoba, kwa ajili ya kuendesha huduma na kukusaidia tu. Hatuuzi taarifa zako wala kuzitoa kwa mtu mwingine. Ujumbe hupita kupitia WhatsApp (Meta), na taarifa huhifadhiwa kwenye kompyuta za kampuni inayotupa seva.

Kwa muda gani

Mpaka utakapozifuta. Nakala za akiba (backup) hukaa siku 14, kisha hujifuta zenyewe.

Uamuzi wako

- Kuona rekodi zako: tuma **dashibodi**, au **leo**, **wiki**, **mwezi**.
- Kurekebisha rekodi: tuma **rekebisha 6000** au **futa**.
- Kufuta kila kitu: tuma **FUTA DATA**, kisha thibitisha kwa **FUTA KABISA**.
- Kusitisha muhtasari wa jioni: tuma **ACHA RIPOTI**.



It explains:

- **What is stored:** your WhatsApp number, the name and business type you give, your messages to Mkoba, and the records made from them, including names of people in your debt records and pasted mobile-money messages.
- **Why:** only to keep your records and send your summaries.
- **Who sees it:** you; the Mkoba team only to run and support the service. Data is not sold or shared. Messages pass through WhatsApp (Meta), and data is stored on the server provider's computers.
- **How long:** until you delete it. Backup copies are kept 14 days, then deleted automatically.
- **Your choices:** see, fix and delete your records, and stop evening reports.

The page shows a contact line and the data location only when the administrator has set them (15.3).

11.4 Delete all your data

This removes **everything** about you from Mkoba: your name, all records, debts, messages, dashboard logins and statement links. It **cannot be undone**.

1. Send `FUTA DATA` (also `futa taarifa`, `futa taarifa zangu`, `futa data zangu`, `futa akaunti`, `futa akaunti yangu`, `delete my data`, `delete account`).
2. Mkoba warns: `Hii itafuta KABISA jina lako, rekodi zako zote, madeni na ujumbe wako wote kwenye Mkoba. Haiwezi kurudishwa. Kuthibitisha, andika FUTA KABISA ndani ya dakika 10.`

3. If you are sure, send `FUTA KABISA` (English: `DELETE EVERYTHING`) **within 10 minutes**.
4. Mkoba replies: `Taarifa zako zote zimefutwa. Nakala za akiba (backup) hujifuta zenyewe ndani ya siku 14. Ukituma ujumbe tena, utaanza upya.`

If you change your mind, just do not send step 3; nothing happens. If you send `FUTA KABISA` without step 1, or after 10 minutes, Mkoba replies `Hakuna ombi la kufuta linalosubiri...` and deletes nothing.

After deletion, any message you send starts Mkoba from the beginning, as a new user. Your WhatsApp chat history on your own phone is not affected; delete it in WhatsApp if you wish.

Not the same as `futa`: `futa` alone deletes only your last record (5.2).

12. Everyday workflows

These combine the features above into complete routines. Each step names the chapter with more detail.

12.1 A normal business day

1. **Morning, buying stock:** after paying, send for example `nimenunua viazi kilo 20 kwa 30000` and `nimelipa nauli 2000`. Check each reply starts with `Sawa!` (4.2).
2. **During the day, selling:** send sales as they happen, or in groups: `nimeuza chips 12000`, `nimeuza soda 10` (price memory asks to confirm; reply `NDIO`) (4.1, 4.7).
3. **Credit sales:** `Mama Neema anadaiwa 3000` (7.1).
4. **Mistake?** Send `futa` or `rekebisha 6500` immediately after (chapter 5).
5. **Evening:** at 21:00 the evening report arrives. Or send `leo` any time to see today's result (chapter 6).

12.2 End of the week

1. On Sunday evening the report covers the whole week and lists customers who owe you.
2. Send `madeni` to see all debts with their age (7.5).
3. For each customer who owes you, send `deni <name>` and forward the reminder (7.6).
4. Send `wiki` or open the dashboard with `dashibodi` to see the week's profit and the 14-day chart (chapter 9).

12.3 Applying for a loan

1. Make sure your records for the last months are complete and correct.
2. Send `taarifa ya biashara` and open the link to check it (10.1).
3. Share the link with the lender (10.2), or print it to PDF.
4. After the decision, send `FUNGA TAARIFA` to close the link (10.4).

12.4 Paying a supplier with Airtel Money

1. Pay the supplier with Airtel Money as usual.
2. Copy the confirmation SMS and paste it into the Mkoba chat (8.1).
3. If it was a till or merchant payment, reply `NDIO`. If it went to a person, reply `1` for stock, `2` for a business cost or `3` if personal (8.2, 8.3).

12.5 Using a new phone or new WhatsApp number

- **Same WhatsApp number on a new phone:** nothing to do. Your records are on Mkoba's server, not on the phone. Send `dashibodi` again to log in to the dashboard on the new phone.
- **New WhatsApp number:** Mkoba knows you by your number, so a new number starts as a **new user** with no records. Records cannot be moved between numbers in the current version.

13. Managing your records over time

13.1 Where your records are

Your records are stored on Mkoba's server, linked to your WhatsApp number. They are not stored on your phone, so losing or changing your phone does not lose them (12.5). Deleting the WhatsApp chat on your phone also does not delete them; only `FUTA DATA` does (11.4).

13.2 Ways to look at your records

You want	Do this
Totals for today, yesterday, this week, this month or all time	Send `leo`, `jana`, `wiki`, `mwezi` or `salio` (chapter 6)

You want	Do this
Your 12 most recent records with date and time	Open the dashboard, section **Rekodi za karibuni** (chapter 9)
Profit per day for the last 14 days	Dashboard chart (chapter 9)
Monthly totals for the last 6 months	Business statement (chapter 10)
Debts	Send `madeni` or `deni <name>` (7.5)

The Lite App shows your 30 latest records (chapter 32). There is no full list of every record and no spreadsheet download.

13.3 What you can and cannot change

Change	Possible?	How
Amount of the last record	Yes	`rekebisha <amount>` (5.3)
Delete the last record, then the one before, and so on	Yes	`futa`, repeated (5.2), or USSD option 8
Delete one of your 30 latest records directly	Yes, in the Lite App	**Futa** next to the record (32.2)
Kind, item or quantity of a record	Only by deleting and re-sending	`futa`, then send again
An older record	No	Ask the administrator (chapter 20)
Date of a record	No (except records typed offline in the Lite App, which keep the time typed)	Records get the time they were received (4.10)
Your name or business type after sign-up	No	Ask the administrator
Everything	Yes, delete all	`FUTA DATA` then `FUTA KABISA` (11.4)

13.4 Good habits

- Record each sale or cost the same day, ideally as it happens.
- Read every reply. `Sawa!` = saved; a question = not saved yet.
- Use the same item names (`chips` , not sometimes `chipsi`) so best-seller lines and price memory work.
- Use the same name for each debtor.
- Do not record money you move between your own accounts; it is not a sale or a cost.

14. Messages Mkoba sends you

The Swahili text of every kind of reply, what it means and what to do next. English replies say the same thing in English. Parts in angle brackets change with your message.

Mkoba says (starts with)	Meaning	What to do
`Karibu Mkoba! 👋 ... Jibu NAKUBALI kuendelea.`	Welcome and data terms	Read, then reply `NAKUBALI` (chapter 2, 11.2)
`Kabla ya kuanza, tafadhali kubali masharti...`	You have not agreed yet	Reply `NAKUBALI`
`Asante! Kwanza, jina lako ni nani?`	Asking your name	Send your name, or `ruka` to skip
`Asante <name>! Unafanya biashara gani?...`	Asking your business type	Send it (e.g. `chakula`), or `ruka`
`Safi, <name>! Sasa uko tayari.` + help list	Sign-up finished	Start recording
`Sawa! Nimeongeza ... Asante!`	Saved	Nothing
`Nimeelewa hivi: ... Jibu NDIO au HAPANA.`	Not saved yet, needs your check	`NDIO` or `HAPANA` within 1 hour (5.1)
`<item> <n> kwa bei gani?...`	Count without price, no earlier price	Send again with the total amount (4.7)
`Samahani, sikuelewa vizuri...`	Nothing saved	Send again with action word and amount (4.8)

Mkoba says (starts with)	Meaning	What to do
`Sawa, sijahifadhi...`	You said HAPANA; nothing saved	Send it again correctly
`Nimefuta ...`	Last record deleted	Nothing
`Nimerekebisha ...: <old> → <new>.`	Amount changed	Nothing
`Hakuna rekodi ya kubadilisha.`	Nothing to delete or change	Nothing
`Ujumbe wako wa mwisho ulikuwa na rekodi <n>...`	`rekebisha` cannot pick one of several	`futa`, then send again (5.3)
`📊 Muhtasari wa <period>:`	Your summary	Read (6.2)
`Hakuna rekodi za <period> bado.`	Nothing recorded in that period	Nothing
`Habari <name>! ... Kusitisha ripoti hizi, andika ACHA RIPOTI.`	Evening report	Read, or `ACHA RIPOTI` to stop (6.4)
`Sawa! <name> anadaiwa ...` `Salio: ...` (and other debt forms)	Debt saved, new balance	Nothing (7.1)
`Kiasi gani? Mfano: ...`	Debt without amount	Send again with amount
`📒 Madeni:`	Debt list	Read (7.5)
`Unaweza kumtumia <name> ujumbe unaofuata...` + reminder	Ready reminder	Forward the second message (7.6)
`Umetuma TSh ... Hii ni nini? ... Jibu 1, 2 au 3.`	Money sent to a person	`1`, `2` or `3` (8.3)
`Muamala huu (...) tayari umeshawekwa kwenye hesabu.`	SMS already recorded	Nothing (8.5)
`Huu ni uhamisho wa pesa zako mwenyewe...` / `...kadi ya benki...` / `...kwa TSh tu...`	SMS recognised, not saved	Nothing (8.4)

Mkoba says (starts with)	Meaning	What to do
`Fungua dashibodi yako hapa...`	Dashboard link	Open within 15 minutes, tap Ingia (9.1)
`Taarifa yako ya biashara iko tayari...`	Statement link	Check, then share (10.1)
`Sawa, viungo vyote vya taarifa yako ya biashara vimefungwa.`	Statement links closed	Nothing
`Sawa, nitajibu kwa Kiswahili...` / `OK, I'll reply in English...`	Language changed	Nothing (11.1)
`Hii itafuta KABISA ...`	Deletion warning	`FUTA KABISA` within 10 minutes, or ignore (11.4)
`Taarifa zako zote zimefutwa...`	All data deleted	Nothing
`Samahani, bado siwezi kusikiliza ujumbe wa sauti...`	You sent a voice note	Type it instead (4.9)
`Samahani, ninaelewa ujumbe wa maandishi tu...`	You sent a photo, sticker, file, etc.	Type it instead
`Samahani, kuna tatizo la mfumo...`	Error on Mkoba's side	Wait a few minutes, send again (chapter 16)

Mkoba sends **no reply** to emoji reactions, and none when the same WhatsApp message is delivered to it twice.

Version 2.0 messages (stock, receipts, shop orders, bulk buying, score, lenders, delivery, payments, voice) are quoted in the chapter for each feature (chapters 21–32). Two replies above change once voice notes are set up: a voice note gets `🎤 Nimesikia: "..."` (what Mkoba heard) and is then handled as text, instead of `Samahani, bado siwezi kusikiliza ujumbe wa sauti...`.

15. Administrator guide

This chapter is for the person who runs Mkoba, not for vendors. It assumes access to the server and to the GitHub repository. No passwords, tokens or keys are written in this manual; they live only in the server's `.env` file.

For the version 2.0 admin pages (bulk buying, lenders, riders, payments), new settings, outside services and the setup checklist, see chapter 33.

15.1 The admin page

1. Open `https://mkoba.digital/admin` in a browser.
2. The browser asks for a user name and password. Enter user name `admin` and the password set as `ADMIN_PASSWORD` in `.env`.
3. The admin page opens.

Mkoba admin

2 vendors	**2** active, 7 days	**2** active, 30 days	**1** new this week	**16** messages today	**102** entries, 30 days	**TSh 744,000** sales recorded, 30 days

0% not understood, 14 days

Still onboarding: 0. Using English: 1. Evening reports off: 1. Mobile-money entries, 30 days: 4. Evening reports sent, 7 days: 0.

Last 14 days

Day	Messages	Active vendors	Entries	Not understood	Rate	Rejected	Corrected
Thu 22/10	16	2	2	1	6%	0	0
Wed 21/10	24	2	4	0	0%	1	0
Tue 20/10	24	2	4	0	0%	0	0
Mon 19/10	24	2	1	0	0%	0	0
Sun 18/10	24	2	4	0	0%	0	0
Sat 17/10	24	2	5	0	0%	0	0
Fri 16/10	24	2	4	0	0%	0	0
Thu 15/10	24	2	4	0	0%	0	0
Wed 14/10	24	2	4	0	0%	0	0
Tue 13/10	24	2	0	0	0%	0	0
Mon 12/10	24	2	4	0	0%	0	0
Sun 11/10	24	2	4	0	0%	0	0
Sat 10/10	22	2	5	0	0%	0	0
Fri 09/10	0	0	4	0	–	0	0

Rate is not-understood messages as a share of text messages. Rejected means the vendor answered NO to a confirmation; corrected means they fixed an amount. Both are signs the parser misread something.

Parser failures to review (2)

When	Vendor	Signal	Message
21/10 14:50	John Demo	rejected	sold soda 12 for 7200
22/10 12:50	Asha Demo	not understood	nimepiga hela 5000

After adding cases to test.js and fixing the parser, mark them reviewed on the server: `sudo -u mkoba node review.js --done`

Vendors

Name	Phone	Business	Lang	Joined	Last message	Entries 30d	Sales 30d	Status
Asha Demo	255700000123	chakula	sw	22/03/26	22/10 14:50	102	TSh 744,000	reports on
John Demo	255700000456	shop	en	22/10/26	22/10 13:50	0	TSh 0	reports off

What it shows:

- **Summary boxes:** total vendors; active in the last 7 and 30 days; new in 7 days; vendors still in sign-up; English users; reports turned off; messages today; records, sales and mobile-money records in 30 days; evening reports sent in 7 days; parser failures not yet reviewed.
- **Last 14 days:** per day, messages, active vendors, records saved, and parser quality: not understood, rate, rejected (vendor said HAPANA) and corrected (vendor used rekebisha).
- **Parser failures to review:** messages Mkoba did not understand, or that vendors rejected or corrected.
- **Vendors:** name, phone, business, language, join date, last message, records and sales in 30 days, and status.

Security rules: if `ADMIN_PASSWORD` is not set, the page does not exist ("Not Found"). After 5 wrong passwords from one address within 15 minutes, that address is blocked for 15 minutes.

15.2 Reviewing parser failures

On the server, in the app folder:

1. Run `node review.js` to list unreviewed failures, each with what the parser does with that text now.
2. Add important cases to `test.js`, fix `parser.js`, and run `node test.js` until all tests pass.
3. Deploy (15.5).
4. Run `node review.js --done` to mark the listed failures as reviewed.

15.3 Settings (.env)

The file `.env` in the app folder holds the settings. `.env.example` in the repository lists them without values.

Setting	Purpose
`DATABASE_URL`, `DATABASE_SSL`	PostgreSQL connection
`WHATSAPP_TOKEN`, `WHATSAPP_PHONE_NUMBER_ID`	Sending WhatsApp messages (Meta Cloud API)

Setting	Purpose
`META_APP_SECRET`	Checking that webhook calls really come from Meta
`WEBHOOK_VERIFY_TOKEN`	Meta's one-time webhook verification
`PORT`	Port the app listens on (3000 in production, behind nginx)
`PUBLIC_URL`	Base address used in links (default `https://mkoba.digital`)
`ADMIN_PASSWORD`	Admin page password; unset = admin page off
`PRIVACY_CONTACT`	Contact line on the privacy page; unset = no contact line
`DATA_LOCATION`, `DATA_LOCATION_SW`	Where data is stored, shown on the privacy page (English, Swahili)
`REPORT_TEMPLATE`, `REPORT_TEMPLATE_LANG`	Approved template for evening reports (default `mkoba_muhtasari`, `sw`)
`LOG_LEVEL`	Amount of logging
`DRY_RUN`	Testing only: no WhatsApp messages are really sent

After changing `.env`, reload the app (15.4).

15.4 Running the service

Part	What it is	Useful commands
App	PM2 process `mkoba-app`, 2 instances, folder `/var/www/mkobalabs`	`pm2 status`, `pm2 logs mkoba-app`, `pm2 startOrReload ecosystem.config.js` (reload without downtime)
Web server	nginx site `mkoba`, HTTPS certificate from Certbot, forwards to port 3000	`sudo nginx -t`, `sudo systemctl reload nginx`
Evening reports	systemd timer `mkoba-reports.timer`, 21:00 Tanzania time	`systemctl list-timers`, `journalctl -u mkoba-reports`

Part	What it is	Useful commands
Backups	systemd timer `mkoba-backup.timer`, 02:30 daily, script `/usr/local/bin/mkoba-backup.sh`, 14 days kept	`journalctl -u mkoba-backup`
Health	`https://mkoba.digital/health`	Returns `{"status":"ok"}`; otherwise a 503 with the reason (`database` or `whatsapp_...`)

An UptimeRobot keyword monitor watches the health address and alerts when it is not "ok". Logs are structured JSON with phone numbers masked.

15.5 Deploying changes

1. Commit and push the change to GitHub (repository `oporoke/mkobalabs`).
2. GitHub Actions runs the tests (`npm ci`, syntax check, `node test.js`).
3. If they pass, it connects to the server and runs `git pull`, `npm install --omit=dev`, `node migrate.js` and `pm2 startOrReload`.
4. Check the **Actions** tab on GitHub for a green tick, then open `/health`.

Database changes are numbered files in `migrations/`. `node migrate.js` applies only the ones not yet applied (recorded in the `schema_migrations` table).

15.6 When WhatsApp sending fails

If `/health` shows `whatsapp_auth`, the WhatsApp token has expired or was revoked. Create a new token in Meta's developer settings, put it in `.env` as `WHATSAPP_TOKEN`, and reload the app. Never paste tokens into chats, tickets or this manual.

16. Troubleshooting

16.1 For vendors

Problem	Likely cause	What to do
Mkoba does not reply at all	No internet on your phone; wrong number; Mkoba is down	Check your phone has internet and that you are writing to +255 788 001 168. Wait a few minutes and send again. If still nothing, contact support (chapter 20).
Every reply asks me to agree	You have not replied NAKUBALI	Send `NAKUBALI` (11.2)
`Samahani, sikuelewa vizuri`	No action word, or no amount	Write e.g. `nimeuza chips 5000` (4.8)
A small number was not saved as money	Numbers below 100 without "Tsh" are counts (price memory)	Write the total, e.g. `nimeuza maandazi 5 kwa 3000` (4.7)
Saved as the wrong kind	Wrong action word (e.g. `nimelipwa` is a sale)	`futa`, then send again with the right word (4.3)
`nimelipa Juma 2000` became an expense	Debt repayment needs `nimemlipa`	`futa`, then `nimemlipa Juma 2000` (7.4)
I answered NDIO but nothing was saved	More than 1 hour passed, or you sent another record before answering	Send the record again (5.1)
`rekebisha` says the last message had several records	It cannot choose one	`futa`, then send the records again (5.3)
My summary seems too low	Records still waiting for NDIO, or deleted	Check recent records on the dashboard (9)
Debts show the same person twice	Different spellings of the name	Use one name; balance the wrong one with the opposite entry (7.3)

Problem	Likely cause	What to do
Mkoba replies in the wrong language	A message looked clearly English or Swahili	Send `kiswahili` or `english` (11.1)
No evening report	Reports off; nothing recorded that day; not agreed	Send `ANZA RIPOTI`; check you recorded something (6.3)
Dashboard link says it no longer works	Over 15 minutes old or already used	Send `dashibodi` again (9.5)
Dashboard asks me to log in again	30 days passed, you logged out, or a different browser	Send `dashibodi` (9.2)
Lender says the statement link is closed	30 days passed, you closed it, or you made a newer one	Send `taarifa ya biashara` and share the new link (10.4)
Pasted SMS not understood	Not Airtel Money, or money received, or text changed	Type the record (8.6)
`Samahani, kuna tatizo la mfumo`	Temporary server problem	Wait a few minutes, send again. If it continues, contact support.

16.2 For the administrator

Symptom	Check	Fix
`/health` returns 503 `database`	`sudo systemctl status postgresql`; `DATABASE_URL`	Start PostgreSQL; correct `.env`; reload app
`/health` returns 503 `whatsapp_auth`	Token expired or revoked	New token in `.env`, reload (15.6)
`/health` returns 503 `whatsapp_failing`	`pm2 logs mkoba-app` for send errors	Check Meta account status, phone number id and limits
Vendors get no replies, health is ok	Logs show no `message_received`	Check the webhook subscription and URL in Meta's app settings; check nginx

Symptom	Check	Fix
Site shows a different application	nginx or PM2 points at another app	Check `/etc/nginx/sites-available/mkoba` forwards to port 3000 and `pm2 status` shows `mkoba-app` online
No evening reports	`systemctl list-timers`; `journalctl -u mkoba-reports`	Fix the error shown; check the template is approved
Deploy failed	GitHub **Actions** tab	Fix failing tests; check the SSH key secret
Admin page says too many attempts	5 wrong passwords in 15 minutes	Wait 15 minutes

Problems with version 2.0 features (payments, voice notes, USSD, delivery fees, group orders) are covered in 33.6.

17. Frequently asked questions

Does Mkoba cost anything? This manual does not cover pricing. WhatsApp itself uses your normal internet bundle.

Do I need to install an app? No. Mkoba works inside WhatsApp. The dashboard and statement open in your phone's normal browser. If you want screens and offline recording, you can add the optional Lite App (chapter 32); without WhatsApp, use USSD (chapter 31).

Can I use Mkoba in English? Yes. Send `english` (11.1).

Can I send a voice note? Yes, once voice notes are set up (chapter 30). Mkoba shows what it heard, and sales, purchases and expenses from voice wait for `NDIO`.

Can I record something from yesterday? You can send it, but it is dated today, when Mkoba receives it. Record each day's business on that day (4.10).

Can I use other currencies? No, Tanzanian shillings only.

What is the difference between manunuzi and matumizi? Manunuzi are things you buy to sell or to make what you sell (stock, ingredients). Matumizi are running costs (rent, electricity, transport, wages). Both reduce profit; they are shown separately so you can see where money goes.

Do debts change my profit? No. Debts are tracked separately (chapter 7). Record the sale when the customer pays if you want it in sales.

Will Mkoba send messages to my customers? No. Mkoba only writes to you. You decide whether to forward a debt reminder (7.6).

Can two people record for the same business? Each WhatsApp number is its own business account. Two phones make two separate sets of records.

Who can see my records? You, and the Mkoba team only to run the service. A lender sees only the totals on a statement link you share (10.3, 11.3).

Is the business statement proof for a bank? It shows your own records and says clearly that Mkoba has not verified them. Each lender decides how to use it.

What happens if I stop using Mkoba? Your records stay until you delete them with `FUTA DATA` (11.4). Evening reports only come on days you record something.

I deleted my data by mistake. Can it be restored? No. Deletion is permanent and cannot be undone by the vendor (11.4).

18. Glossary

Word	Meaning
Mauzo	Sales: money in from selling
Manunuzi	Purchases: stock or ingredients bought
Matumizi	Expenses: running costs
Gharama	Costs (purchases plus expenses), used on the statement
Faida	Profit: sales minus purchases minus expenses
Hasara	Loss: when costs are more than sales
Muhtasari	Summary
Salio	Balance; the `salio` command shows totals since you started
Deni / madeni	Debt / debts
Unaowadai	People who owe you

Word	Meaning
Wanaokudai	People you owe
Dashibodi	The web dashboard
Taarifa ya biashara	Business statement for lenders
Rekodi	A record (one sale, purchase, expense or debt entry)
NDIO / HAPANA	Yes / No, to confirm or cancel
NAKUBALI	I agree (to the data terms)
futa	Delete the last record
rekebisha	Correct the amount of the last record
Ingia / Toka	Log in / Log out
Kiungo	Link
Price memory	Mkoba using your last price for an item to work out a total from a count
Evening report	The automatic 21:00 summary
Template	A message format approved by WhatsApp, used for reports when you have not written for 23 hours
TID	Transaction number on an Airtel Money SMS
SACCO	Savings and credit cooperative

Version 2.0 words

Word	Meaning
Stoo	Stock: the goods you have
Risiti	Receipt
Pointi	Loyalty points a customer collects
Bidhaa	Products in your shop's catalog
Oda	An order from a customer

Word	Meaning
Duka (number)	Your shop number, which customers send to order
Kikundi / vikundi	Group / groups for bulk buying, each at a collection point
Jirani	Jirani Bulk Buy, the weekly group order
Pokea	Where you receive bulk goods
Alama	The Mkoba credit score
Mkopeshaji / wakopeshaji	Lender / lenders
Ruhusa	Permission for a lender to see your records
Boda / kazi	Delivery rider / delivery job
Lipa	Pay (by phone, through Selcom)
USSD	Codes like *150…#* that work on any phone without internet
Lite App	The installable web app for vendors (chapter 32)

19. Quick reference card

All commands must be the whole message unless an example shows more.

To do this	Send
Record a sale	`nimeuza chips 5000`
Record a purchase	`nimenunua mchele kilo 10 kwa 25000`
Record an expense	`nimelipa umeme 15000`
Several at once	One per line
Confirm / cancel	`NDIO` / `HAPANA`
Delete last record	`futa`
Fix last amount	`rekebisha 6500`
Today / yesterday	`leo` / `jana`

To do this	Send
This week / this month / all time	`wiki` / `mwezi` / `salio`
Someone owes you	`namdai Juma 5000` or `Juma anadaiwa 5000`
You owe someone	`Juma ananidai 5000`
They paid you	`Juma amelipa 2000`
You paid them	`nimemlipa Juma 2000`
All debts / one person	`madeni` / `deni Juma`
Mobile-money SMS	Paste the Airtel Money SMS unchanged
Dashboard link	`dashibodi`
Business statement / close it	`taarifa ya biashara` / `FUNGA TAARIFA`
Evening reports off / on	`ACHA RIPOTI` / `ANZA RIPOTI`
Language	`english` / `kiswahili`
Help list	`msaada`
Delete everything	`FUTA DATA`, then `FUTA KABISA` within 10 minutes

Version 2.0 commands

To do this	Send
See stock / set a count	`stoo` / `stoo mchele kilo 20`
Own low-stock level / automatic	`stoo mchele chini ya 5` / `stoo mchele chini ya auto`
Receipt for a customer	`risiti 0712345678 chips 5000`
Customer points / top customers / use points	`pointi 0712345678` / `pointi` / `tumia pointi 0712345678 20`
Products / add / sold out / back / remove	`bidhaa` / `bidhaa ongeza chips 3000` / `bidhaa imeisha chips` / `bidhaa ipo chips` / `bidhaa ondoa chips`
Orders / one order	`oda` / `oda 1`

To do this	Send
Accept / reject / complete an order	`kubali oda 1` / `kataa oda 1` / `maliza oda 1`
Customer: open a shop / order / send / leave	`duka 4108` / `1x2, 3` / `TUMA` / `TOKA`
Groups / join / create / my group / leave	`vikundi` / `jiunge SIN01` / `unda kikundi Jina, Eneo` / `kikundi` / `toka kikundi`
Bulk order: add / see / remove / goods arrived	`jirani mchele kilo 20` / `jirani` / `jirani ondoa mchele` / `jirani imefika`
Where to receive bulk goods	`pokea nyumbani <anwani>` / `pokea <mahali>` / `pokea kikundi`
Household sign-up	`nyumbani`
Credit score	`alama`
Lenders / allow / decline / remove access	`wakopeshaji` / `ruhusu NMB` / `kataa NMB` / `ondoa ruhusa NMB`
Pay a waiting payment by phone	`LIPA`
Rider: apply / jobs / take / picked up / delivered / give back	`boda` / `kazi` / `chukua 12` / `nimechukua 12` / `nimefikisha 12` / `acha 12`
Rider: stop / start job alerts	`zima` / `washa`
Record by voice	Send a voice note (chapter 30)
Lite App	`https://mkoba.digital/d/app` (log in with `dashibodi`)

20. Help and support

20.1 Help inside Mkoba

- Send `msaada` (or `help`, `menu`) at any time for the list of commands.
- Read the privacy page: `https://mkoba.digital/faragha` (Swahili) or `/privacy` (English).

20.2 Contacting the Mkoba team

For anything Mkoba cannot do by itself (changing your name, fixing an old record, questions about your data), contact the Mkoba team. The contact shown on the privacy page is the official one. **Support contact: to be confirmed by the Mkoba team before this manual is published.**

When you ask for help, give: your WhatsApp number, what you sent, what Mkoba replied, and the date and time. Never send anyone your WhatsApp codes or passwords; the Mkoba team will never ask for them.

20.3 Reporting a wrong answer

You do not need to report each misunderstanding. When Mkoba says `sikuelewa`, when you answer `HAPANA`, or when you use `rekebisha`, the message is recorded automatically for the team to review and improve Mkoba (15.2).

Part II – Version 2.0 features

Chapters 21–33 describe the features added in version 2.0. Chapters 1–20 still apply unchanged, except where a chapter below says otherwise. All new WhatsApp commands work in Swahili and English, and `msaada` now lists them.

Chapter	Feature	Who uses it	Needs setting up first?
21	Stock and low-stock alerts	Vendors	No
22	Customer receipts and loyalty points	Vendors	No
23	Shop catalog and customer orders	Vendors, customers	No
24	Jirani Bulk Buy (group buying)	Vendors, administrator	Collection points and wholesale prices on the admin page
25	Household group buys	Households	Same as chapter 24
26	Mkoba credit score	Vendors, lenders	No

Chapter	Feature	Who uses it	Needs setting up first?
27	Lenders and the lender portal	Vendors, lenders, administrator	Lenders added on the admin page
28	Boda delivery	Vendors, customers, households, riders	Riders and fee settings on the admin page
29	Paying by phone (Selcom)	Customers, households, administrator	Selcom account and keys
30	Voice notes	Everyone already using Mkoba	Google Cloud Speech-to-Text
31	USSD menus for basic phones	Vendors	Africa's Talking USSD channel and shortcode
32	The Lite App	Vendors	No
33	Administrator guide for version 2.0	Administrator	–

A feature that needs setting up stays switched off until it is, and the rest of Mkoba works as normal.

21. Stock (stoo)

Mkoba keeps a count of the goods you have, from the records you already send, and warns you before something runs out.

21.1 How the count works

- A **purchase with a quantity** adds to stock: `nimenunua mchele kilo 10 kwa 25000` adds 10 kg of mchele.
- A **sale with a quantity** takes from stock: `nimeuza mchele kilo 2 kwa 6000` takes 2 kg away.
- Records **without a quantity** (`nimeuza chips 5000`) do not change stock.
- Deleting a record with `futa` puts the stock back.
- Each item is counted per unit: kilos, litres, grams, or pieces (a number with no unit, such as `soda 24`, counts pieces). Kilos and pieces of the same item are counted separately.

21.2 Enter what you have now

1. Send `stoo` followed by the item and amount, for example `stoo mchele kilo 20`.
2. Several items work in one message, one per line or separated by commas: `stoo mafuta lita 5, sukari kilo 2`.
3. Mkoba replies `Sawa! Stoo sasa:` and the list.

This is a **count**: it replaces the old figure, and records from then on add to or take from it. New vendors are invited to do this at the end of sign-up. The first time an item appears in a record with a quantity, Mkoba also asks once: `📦 Ili nifuatilie stoo ya mchele, andika kiasi kilichopo sasa, mfano: stoo mchele kilo 20`.

A money amount is not a count: `stoo mchele 20000 tsh` is refused.

21.3 See your stock

Send `stoo` (English: `stock`). Example:

```
📦 Stoo yako:
- mchele: 18 kg
- soda: 15 (inatosha siku ~14)
- maandazi: ? (andika kiasi kilichopo: stoo maandazi 20)
⚠️ = inakaribia kuisha
```

- `(inatosha siku ~14)` = about how many days it will last at your recent selling speed.
- `?` = Mkoba cannot count it yet (you only recorded sales of it). Enter a count as in 21.2.
- `⚠️` = running low.

21.4 Low-stock alerts

Automatic (default): once an item has had at least 3 sales with a quantity in the last 14 days, Mkoba warns when about **2 days of sales** are left.

Your own level: send `stoo mchele chini ya 5` (English: `stock rice below 5`). Mkoba replies `Sawa! Nitakuambia stoo ya mchele ikifika 5 kg au chini.` To go back to automatic: `stoo mchele chini ya auto`.

The warning comes **once**, in the reply to the sale that crosses the level: `⚠️ Stoo ya mchele inakaribia kuisha: imebaki 5 kg.` When an item reaches zero: `⚠️ mchele: stoo imeisha (kwa hesabu yako).`

Low items are also listed in the evening report (`⚠️ Stoo inakaribia kuisha: ...`) and on the dashboard in a new **Stoo** section.

22. Customer receipts and loyalty points

Give a customer a WhatsApp receipt for a sale, and they collect points that you can reward.

22.1 Give a receipt

1. Send `risiti` , the customer's phone number, then what they bought: `risiti 0712345678 chips 5000`
2. Several items work, one per line. The word `nimeuza` is not needed.
3. Mkoba saves the sale (and updates stock) and sends you **two messages**: a confirmation, and the receipt itself.
4. Press and hold the receipt, tap **Sambaza** (Forward), and send it to the customer.

```
🧾 Risiti R-0001 – Neema – chakula
22/10/2026 19:06
- Chips TSh 5,000
- Soda (2) TSh 1,200
Jumla: TSh 6,200
Pointi: +6 (jumla 6)
Asante kwa kununua!
```

Receipts are numbered for your shop (R-0001, R-0002, …). Mkoba does not message the customer itself; you forward the receipt. The phone number must be a Tanzanian mobile number starting 06 or 07 (or 2556/2557).

22.2 Points

- The customer gets **1 point for every full TSh 1,000** on a receipt.
- If you delete a receipt sale with `futa` , or change its amount with `rekebisha` , the points change with it.
- One customer: `pointi 0712345678` → `0712345678: pointi 6 (ununuzi 1, jumla TSh 6,200).`
- Your top 10 customers: `pointi`

22.3 Use points

You decide what points are worth (for example 20 points = a free soda). When a customer uses points:

1. Send `tumia pointi 0712345678 20`.
2. If they have too few, Mkoba replies with how many they have and nothing changes.
3. Otherwise Mkoba replies with the new balance and gives you a message to forward to the customer.

English: `receipt 0712345678 chips 5000`, `points`, `redeem 0712345678 20`.

23. Your shop: catalog and customer orders

Put your products and prices in Mkoba. Customers then order from you on WhatsApp or on a web page, and you accept, reject or complete orders.

23.1 Set up your products (vendor)

To do this	Send
Add products, or change a price	`bidhaa ongeza chips 3000, soda 600` (several at once, by comma or line)
See your list, shop number and links	`bidhaa`
Mark sold out / back in stock	`bidhaa imeisha chips` / `bidhaa ipo chips` (or the number from the list)
Remove a product	`bidhaa ondoa chips`

`bidhaa` shows your **shop number** (for example `duka 4108`), the web link (`https://mkoba.digital/k/4108`) and a WhatsApp link to share. English: `catalog`, `catalog add`, `catalog out`, `catalog in`, `catalog remove`.

23.2 How a customer orders on WhatsApp

1. The customer sends `duka 4108` to the Mkoba number (or opens your WhatsApp link). They get your numbered list.
2. They send numbers and quantities, for example `1x2, 2` (two of item 1, one of item 2). `KIKAPU` shows the cart, `futa kikapu` empties it, `MENYU` shows the list again.

3. They send `TUMA`. Mkoba asks where to deliver. They reply with name and place (`Asha, Sinza Mori karibu na msikiti`), or share a WhatsApp location, or `CHUKUA Asha` to collect themselves.
4. They get `✅ Oda #1 imetumwa ...`, and you get the order.

`TOKA` leaves the shop. The shop visit ends after 2 hours or when the order is sent. English: `shop 4108`, `CART`, `ORDER`, `MENU`, `EXIT`, `PICKUP Asha`. A customer who has ordered before gets an "order again" message rather than vendor sign-up; they can send `SAJILI` to register their own business.

23.3 How a customer orders on the web

On `mkoba.digital/k/4108` the customer chooses quantities, enters name and phone number, and chooses collection or delivery (with a place). After sending, the page shows the order number and, if payments are set up, a **Lipa sasa** button (chapter 29).

23.4 Handle orders (vendor)

To do this	Send
See open orders	`oda`
See one order	`oda 1`
Accept	`kubali oda 1`
Reject	`kataa oda 1`
Complete (paid and handed over)	`maliza oda 1`

- Accepting or rejecting tells the customer. Accepting a delivery order also creates a boda delivery job (chapter 28) and, if payments are set up, sends the customer a payment link (chapter 29).
- **Completing** records the sale (one record per product, so stock and best sellers update), gives the customer points and sends them a receipt.
- English: `orders`, `order 1`, `accept order 1`, `reject order 1`, `complete order 1`. The same buttons are in the Lite App (chapter 32).

23.5 If you have not messaged Mkoba for 24 hours

WhatsApp only lets Mkoba message you within 24 hours of your last message. A new order that arrives later is not lost: it is shown with your next message (`🛒 Una oda mpya: ...`). In the same way, if Mkoba cannot message a customer, it tells you to contact them and gives you the receipt to forward.

23.6 Shopping at another shop

If you (a vendor) send `duka` and a number to order from another shop, your messages go to that shop for up to 2 hours. Send `TOKA` to come back to your own records.

24. Jirani Bulk Buy (group buying)

Vendors near the same **collection point** join a group, put their stock needs into one weekly group order, and buy at wholesale prices.

24.1 Join a group

To do this	Send
See all groups	`vikundi`
Join by code, name or area	`jiunge SIN01`, or `jiunge Sinza`
Find the nearest group	Share your WhatsApp location (📎 > Location). Mkoba suggests the nearest point within 3 km.
Create a group	`unda kikundi Sinza Mori, Sinza` (name, then area)
See your group and its order	`kikundi`
Leave your group	`toka kikundi`

Groups get a code such as SIN01. If several groups match `jiunge Sinza`, Mkoba lists them and you join by code. A group you create also gets your shared location, if you sent one.

24.2 Add to this week's group order

1. Send `jirani` and what you need: `jirani mchele kilo 20`. Several items work: `jirani mchele kilo 10, mafuta lita 5`.
2. Mkoba replies with the group's totals, the wholesale price (or `bei itathibitishwa`, price to be confirmed) and your share.
3. Sending the same item again replaces your quantity. Remove an item with `jirani ondoa mchele`. See the order with `jirani`.

Item names must match the wholesale list the administrator keeps (for example `mchele`, not `rice`), or the item shows "price to be confirmed".

24.3 Suggestions

When you record a purchase (`nimenunua mchele ...`) of something your group buys in bulk, Mkoba adds a tip with the wholesale price and how to add it. If you are not in a group, it suggests joining one. You get at most one such tip a week.

24.4 When the order closes

Group orders close every **Friday at 20:00** and are handled in the 21:00 evening run. Each member gets their share, prices, total and where to collect:

```
🧺 Oda ya jumla ya Sinza Mori imefungwa. Sehemu yako:
- Mchele 20 kg × TSh 2,300 = TSh 46,000
Jumla: TSh 46,000
Utachukua: Sinza Mori, Sinza
Mzigo ukifika, andika: jirani imefika
```

If payments are set up, the message also has a payment link (chapter 29). When the goods reach the collection point, the administrator marks them arrived and members are told.

24.5 Receive your goods

Send `jirani imefika`. Your share is recorded as **purchases** at the wholesale price, which also updates your stock. Items without a price are listed for you to record yourself.

English: `groups`, `join SIN01`, `create group Name, Area`, `group`, `leave group`, `bulk rice kilo 20`, `bulk remove rice`, `bulk received`.

25. Household group buys

Households join the same groups and weekly orders as vendors. The only difference: each household says where it receives its goods.

25.1 Sign up as a household

1. Send `nyumbani` (English: `household`) to the Mkoba number. There is no vendor sign-up.
2. Read the short data notice and reply `NAKUBALI`.
3. Send your name. Mkoba replies with the 3 steps below.

25.2 The 3 steps

1. **Join a group:** `vikundi`, then `jiunge SIN01` (or share your location) – as in 24.1.
2. **Say where to receive your goods.** This is required before your first order, and Mkoba asks for it right after you join:
   - At home: `pokea nyumbani Sinza Mori, nyumba namba 12`
   - At a place: `pokea Kanisa la Sinza`
   - At the group's collection point: `pokea kikundi`
   - See your choice: `pokea`
3. **Order:** `jirani mchele kilo 5, mafuta lita 3`.

When the order closes, you get your share and total, plus `Tutakuletea nyumbani: ...` (we deliver to your home) or `Utachukua: ...` (you collect at ...). Home and place deliveries become boda jobs when the goods arrive (chapter 28). For home delivery, share your WhatsApp location once so the delivery fee can be worked out.

25.3 Other commands

- `jirani` shows the order, `jirani ondoa mchele` removes an item, `jirani imefika` marks your goods received (households keep no business records, so nothing is added to sales or stock).
- `LIPA` pays a waiting payment by phone (chapter 29), `english` / `kiswahili` changes language, `FUTA DATA` deletes your data, `msaada` shows the steps again.
- Other commands (sales records, summaries) are for vendors only. Households do not get evening reports.
- English: `deliver home <address>`, `deliver to <place>`, `collect group`, `delivery`.

Vendors can use the same `pokea ...` command. A vendor who has not chosen collects at the group's point.

26. The Mkoba credit score (alama)

The score turns your last 90 days of records into a number from 0 to 100 that a lender can use. It comes only from your own records.

26.1 See your score

Send `alama` (English: `score`). Example:

```
📈 Alama ya Mkoba: 87/100 (nzuri sana)
- Kuweka rekodi kila siku: 25.7/30
- Faida: 25/25
- Mwenendo wa mauzo: 13.3/15
- Muda wa kutumia Mkoba: 12.5/15
- Madeni: 9.2/10
- Rekodi zilizothibitishwa: 1.6/5

Kuongeza alama:
• bandika SMS za pesa ya simu na tumia risiti ...
```

Up to two tips appear for your weakest parts. The score is also on your dashboard and on the business statement (chapter 10).

26.2 How it is calculated

Part	Points	What earns them
Recording every day	30	Share of days with records, counted over the days since your first record (at least 30, at most 90)
Profit	25	15 for the share of the last three 30-day months in profit, 10 for your margin (30% margin or more = full)
Sales trend	15	Sales in the last 30 days against the 30-day average before. Half or less = 0, 1.2 times or more = full. With under 15 earlier days, a neutral 7.5
Time using Mkoba	15	Days since your first record; 180 days = full

Part	Points	What earns them
Debts	10	What you owe against one month of sales: nothing owed = full, a month of sales or more = 0
Verified records	5	Share of records from mobile-money SMS, receipts, completed shop orders or bulk deliveries; 30% or more = full

Rating: 80+ nzuri sana (A), 65+ nzuri (B), 50+ wastani (C), 35+ chini (D), below 35 chini sana (E).

26.3 When there is no score yet

A score needs at least **14 days with records** over at least **30 days** of use. Until then, `alama` tells you how far you are.

One score is saved per day (when you check it, when a lender looks, and every evening for vendors who allowed a lender), so lenders can see the trend.

27. Lenders

Banks, microfinance and SACCOs connected to Mkoba can see your statement and score, **only after you allow them**, and you can remove access at any time.

27.1 For vendors (WhatsApp)

To do this	Send
See lenders, who has access and since when, and when they last looked	`wakopeshaji`
Allow a lender	`ruhusu NMB` (or `ndio NMB`)
Decline a lender's request	`kataa NMB` (or `hapana NMB`)
Remove access	`ondoa ruhusa NMB`

NMB stands for the lender's code from the `wakopeshaji` list. A lender can also ask you first: you get `🏦 NMB Bank wanaomba ruhusa kuona taarifa yako ya biashara na alama yako ya Mkoba ...` with their message and how to answer. A plain `NDIO` without

the code does not answer a lender, so it is never mixed up with confirming a record. English: `lenders`, `allow NMB`, `decline NMB`, `revoke NMB`.

What a lender sees: the six-month statement (chapter 10) with your full phone number, the score and its parts, the score history, and a log of requests and permissions. Never your individual records or messages. Every time a lender opens your page it is logged, and `wakopeshaji` shows when they last looked.

27.2 For lenders: the portal

1. Open `https://mkoba.digital/l` and log in with the lender code and password given by Mkoba. After 5 wrong tries the address is blocked for 15 minutes; a login lasts 12 hours.
2. **Vendors who gave you access** are listed with business, phone, date and latest score. Click **View** for the statement, score, score history and consent log.
3. **Ask a vendor for access:** enter the vendor's WhatsApp number and an optional message (up to 140 characters), then **Send request**. The answer is the same whether or not the number uses Mkoba, so lenders cannot find out who is a user. At most 30 requests a day.
4. **Your requests** shows each request: waiting, declined or access removed.

The portal is in English. The figures are the vendor's own records, not verified by Mkoba, as the page says.

28. Boda delivery

Riders (boda) on WhatsApp take delivery jobs. The fee is worked out from the distance between the pickup and the drop-off.

28.1 Where delivery jobs come from

- **Customer orders (chapter 23):** when a vendor accepts an order with delivery, a job is created and the fee is sent to the vendor and the customer.
- **Household and vendor bulk shares (chapters 24–25):** when the administrator marks a group's goods as arrived at the collection point, each member who chose home or a named place gets a job. Members who collect at the point get `📦 Mzigo wako wa jumla umefika ...`.

28.2 The fee

Fee = TSh 1,000 + TSh 750 per km, where km is the straight-line distance × 1.3 (an estimate of road distance), rounded up to TSh 500, never below TSh 1,500. For example, about 1.5 km in a straight line costs TSh 2,500. The administrator can change every number.

Both map positions are needed: the vendor's shop or the collection point, and the customer's or household's shared location. Without them the fee is **bei ya kukubaliana** (agreed between rider and customer). So:

- **Vendors:** share your shop's WhatsApp location once (📎 > Location). Mkoba reminds you if you accept a delivery order without it.
- **Customers:** when ordering on WhatsApp, share your location instead of typing a place.
- **Households with home delivery:** share your location once. A named place has no map position.

The customer or household pays the fee, either by phone (chapter 29) or in cash to the rider.

28.3 Updates during a delivery

- Rider takes the job → vendor and customer get the rider's name and phone.
- Rider picks up → the customer gets `🛵 Oda #4 iko njiani kwako.`
- Delivered → the vendor gets `✅ Oda #4 imefikishwa.`
- Households get the same updates for their bulk goods.

28.4 Guide for riders

Joining: send `boda` (English: `rider`) to the Mkoba number, then your full name and your area. You are told when the administrator approves you. The administrator can also add you directly.

To do this	Send
See open jobs, nearest first, with distance and fee	`kazi`
Take job 12	`chukua 12`
You collected the goods	`nimechukua 12`
You delivered	`nimefikisha 12`

To do this	Send
Give a job back	`acha 12`
Stop / start getting job alerts	`zima` / `washa`
Get jobs near you	Share your WhatsApp location
Delete your rider data	`FUTA DATA`

- Jobs are first come, first served. You can have at most **3** unfinished jobs.
- When you take a job you get the pickup and drop-off places with phone numbers, and the fee. If it was already paid by phone, the message says `💳 Imeshalipwa kwa simu: usipokee pesa taslimu.` (do not take cash).
- New jobs within 5 km of you are sent to you straight away, if you have messaged Mkoba in the last 24 hours. Otherwise check with `kazi`.
- Fees paid by phone are paid out to you by Mkoba (chapter 29). English: `jobs`, `take 12`, `picked 12`, `delivered 12`, `drop 12`, `off`, `on`.

29. Paying by phone (Selcom)

Customer orders, bulk-order shares and delivery fees can be paid with mobile money through Selcom. This works once the administrator has set up Selcom (chapter 33).

29.1 How to pay

Every payment request looks like this:

```
💳 Lipa TSh 8,500 kwa simu: andika LIPA (utapokea ombi la PIN), au fungua: https://mkoba.digital/pay/MKB...
```

Pay in either of two ways:

1. **PIN prompt:** send `LIPA` (English: `PAY`). Your phone shows a mobile-money prompt; enter your PIN. Mkoba replies `📲 Angalia simu yako: weka PIN kulipa ...`.
2. **Payment page:** open the link and choose how to pay on Selcom's page.

When the payment is confirmed you get `✅ Malipo ya TSh 8,500 yamepokelewa (oda #4). Asante!`. Mkoba always checks the payment with Selcom itself before marking it paid.

29.2 When payment requests are sent

What	When	Amount
Customer order (WhatsApp)	When the vendor accepts	Order total plus delivery fee, if known
Customer order (web)	Straight away, on the confirmation page (optional)	Order total; the delivery fee is paid to the rider
Bulk share	When the group order closes	The priced part of your share
Household delivery fee	When the goods arrive and the job is created	The fee (if known), or cash to the rider

- Paying is optional for customers: they can still pay cash when they receive the goods.
- The vendor is told when an order is paid (`💳 Oda #4 imelipwa kwa simu ...`), and the rider is told not to take cash.
- A link stays valid for 60 minutes on Selcom's side; `LIPA` works for up to 7 days for the latest waiting payment.
- If a vendor rejects an order that was already paid, it is marked "refund needed" for the administrator.

29.3 Where the money goes

All payments arrive in Mkoba's Selcom account. The administrator then pays vendors their order amounts and riders their delivery fees, and records each payout (chapter 33). Vendors and riders do not receive the money directly from the customer's phone.

30. Voice notes

You can speak instead of typing. This works once the administrator has set up Google Speech-to-Text (chapter 33); until then Mkoba asks you to type.

30.1 Record by voice

1. In the Mkoba chat, hold the microphone button and say the record, for example "nimeuza chips elfu tano".
2. Mkoba first shows what it heard: `🎤 Nimesikia: "nimeuza chips elfu tano"`.

3. It then handles it like a typed message. **Sales, purchases and expenses from voice always wait for `NDIO`**, so check the amount and reply `NDIO` or `HAPANA` (chapter 5).

Voice works for everything you can type: commands such as `leo` or `madeni`, households' `jirani` orders, riders' commands, and customers ordering in a shop. Quantities in words are understood too ("kilo tano" = 5 kg, "lita kumi na mbili" = 12 l).

30.2 Limits

- Voice notes must be **1 minute or shorter**. Longer ones get `Ujumbe wa sauti ni mrefu kuliko dakika 1 ...`.
- If Mkoba hears nothing, or there is a problem, it asks you to try again or type.
- Only people already using Mkoba (vendors and households who agreed, riders, customers in a shop) can use voice. A voice note from a new number gets the normal welcome and is not listened to.
- Swahili is used, or English if you chose English.
- Privacy: the recording is sent to Google to turn it into text. Mkoba keeps the text, not the recording.

31. Mkoba on any phone (USSD)

Vendors without WhatsApp, or without data, can use Mkoba from a basic phone by dialling a USSD code. The code is assigned when the administrator sets up USSD (chapter 33).

31.1 First time

1. Dial the Mkoba code.
2. Read the short notice and choose **1. Nakubali** (I agree), or **2. Hapana** (no) to stop.
3. Type your name and send. You are registered. The same account also works on WhatsApp.

31.2 The menu

Choose	What happens
1. Weka mauzo	Type the item (or 0 to skip), then the amount. Saved straight away.

Choose	What happens
2. Weka manunuzi	Same, for a purchase
3. Weka matumizi	Same, for an expense
4. Muhtasari wa leo	Today's sales, purchases, expenses and profit
5. Muhtasari wa wiki	The same for this week
6. Madeni	Up to 5 debts
7. Stoo	Up to 6 stock items; `!` = running low
8. Futa rekodi ya mwisho	Shows your last record and asks 1. Ndio / 2. Hapana before deleting

- Amounts: type digits, for example `5000` or `5,000`.
- Records from USSD are saved at once (there is no NDIO step), because you choose the type and type the amount in a form.
- Menus follow your language (Swahili or English).
- Households and riders are asked to use WhatsApp. Other features (shop, receipts, bulk buying, payments) are on WhatsApp and the app.

32. The Mkoba Lite App

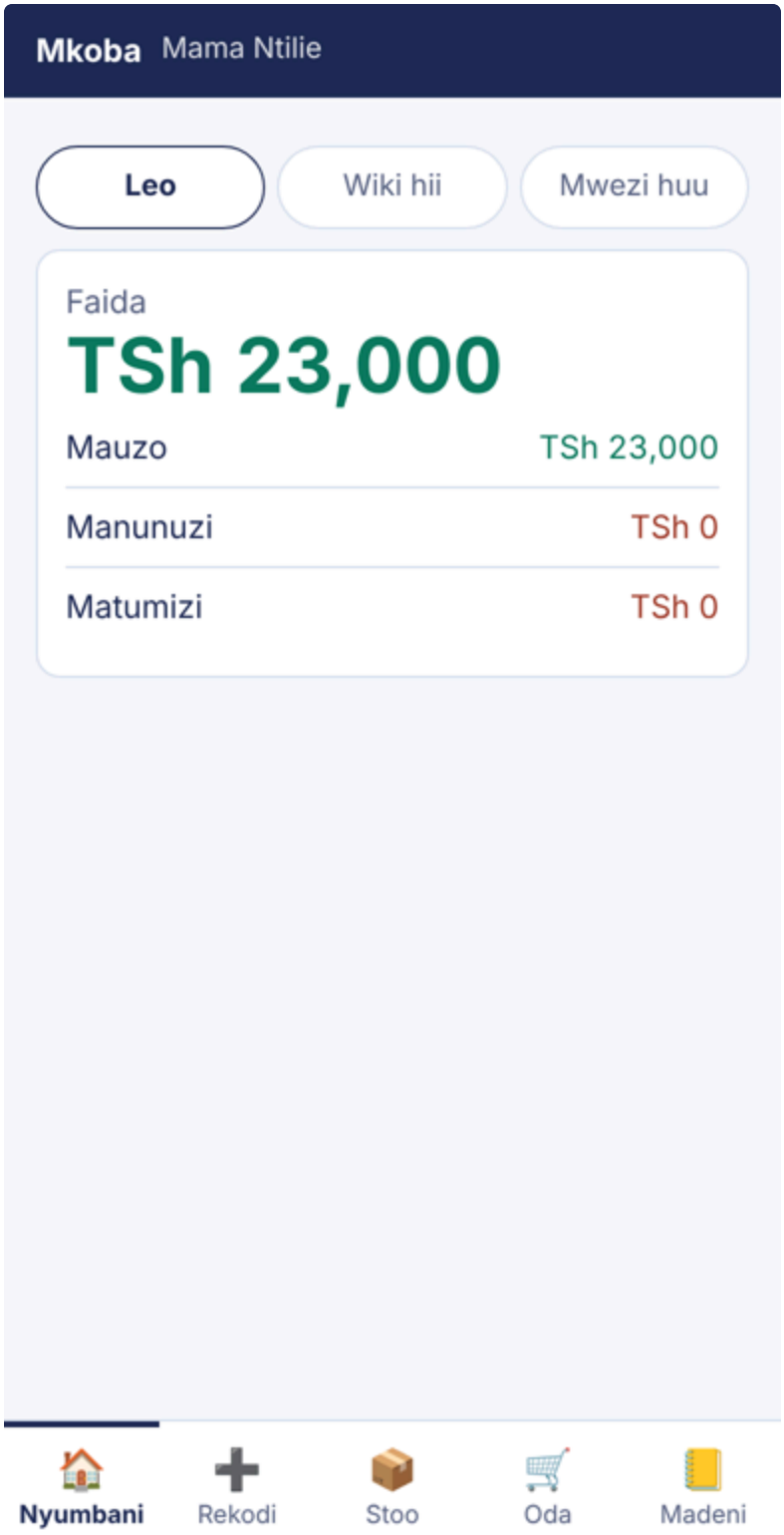
The Lite App is a small app (about 40 KB) that opens in the phone's browser and can be added to the home screen like a normal app. It works offline.

32.1 Open and install

1. Log in as for the dashboard: send `dashibodi` on WhatsApp, open the link, tap **Ingia** (chapter 9).
2. On the dashboard, tap 📱 **Fungua programu ya Mkoba**, or open `https://mkoba.digital/d/app` in the same browser.
3. To install: on Android, tap **Weka Mkoba kwenye skrini ya simu** on the home tab when it appears, or use the browser menu **Add to Home screen**. On iPhone, use **Share > Add to Home Screen**.

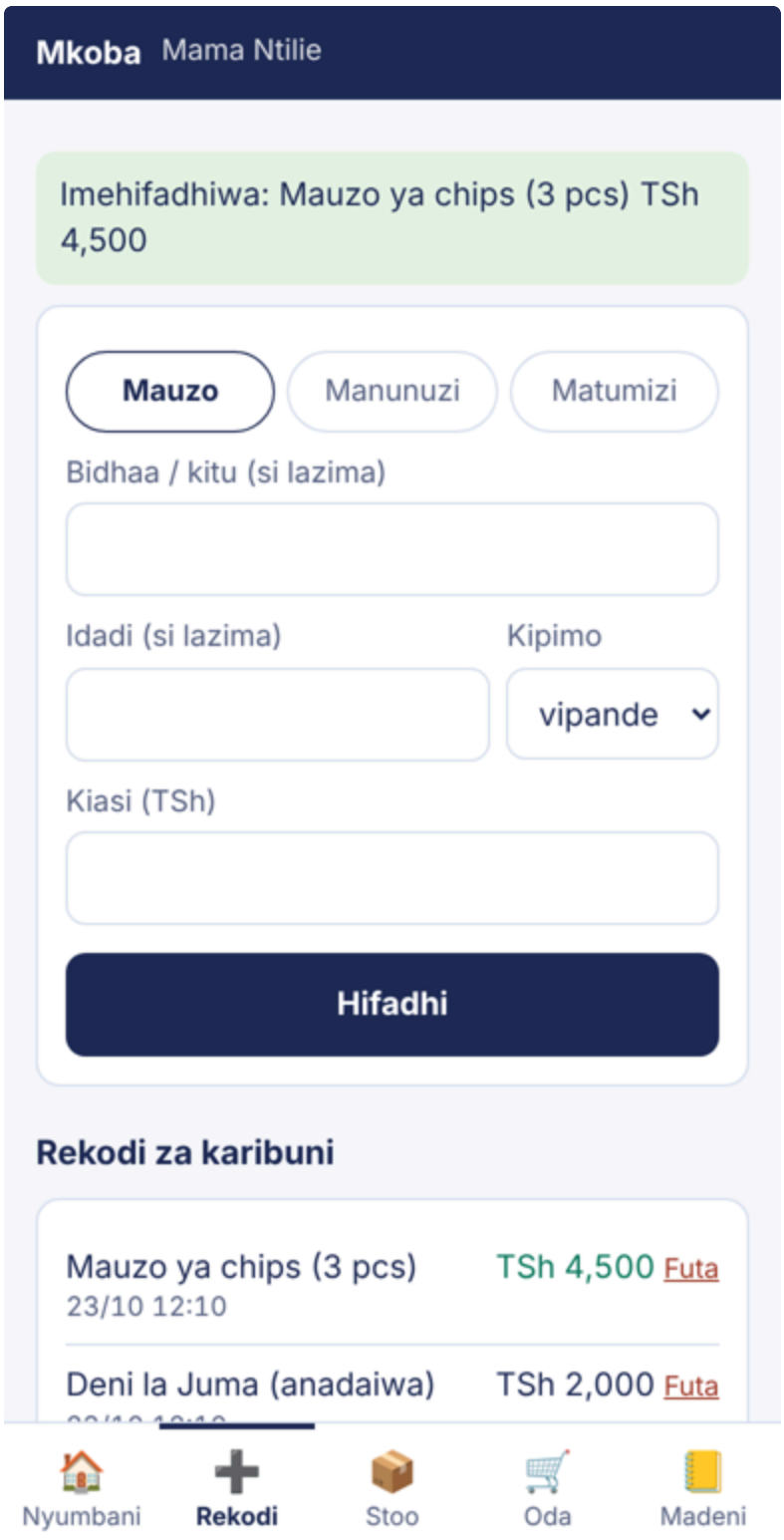
If you are not logged in, the app shows how to log in, with a button that opens WhatsApp. The login lasts 30 days in that browser. Only vendors can use the app.

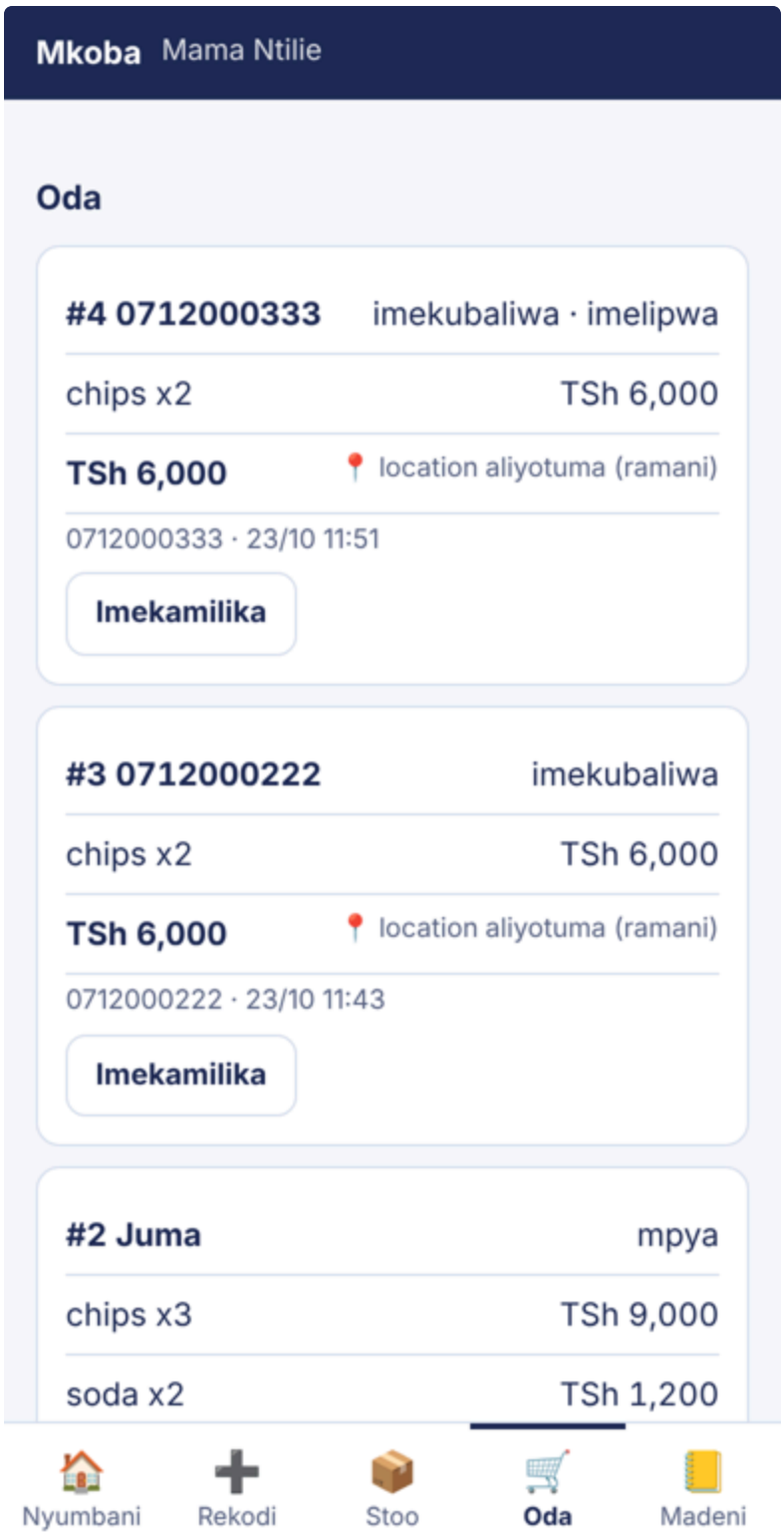
32.2 The five tabs



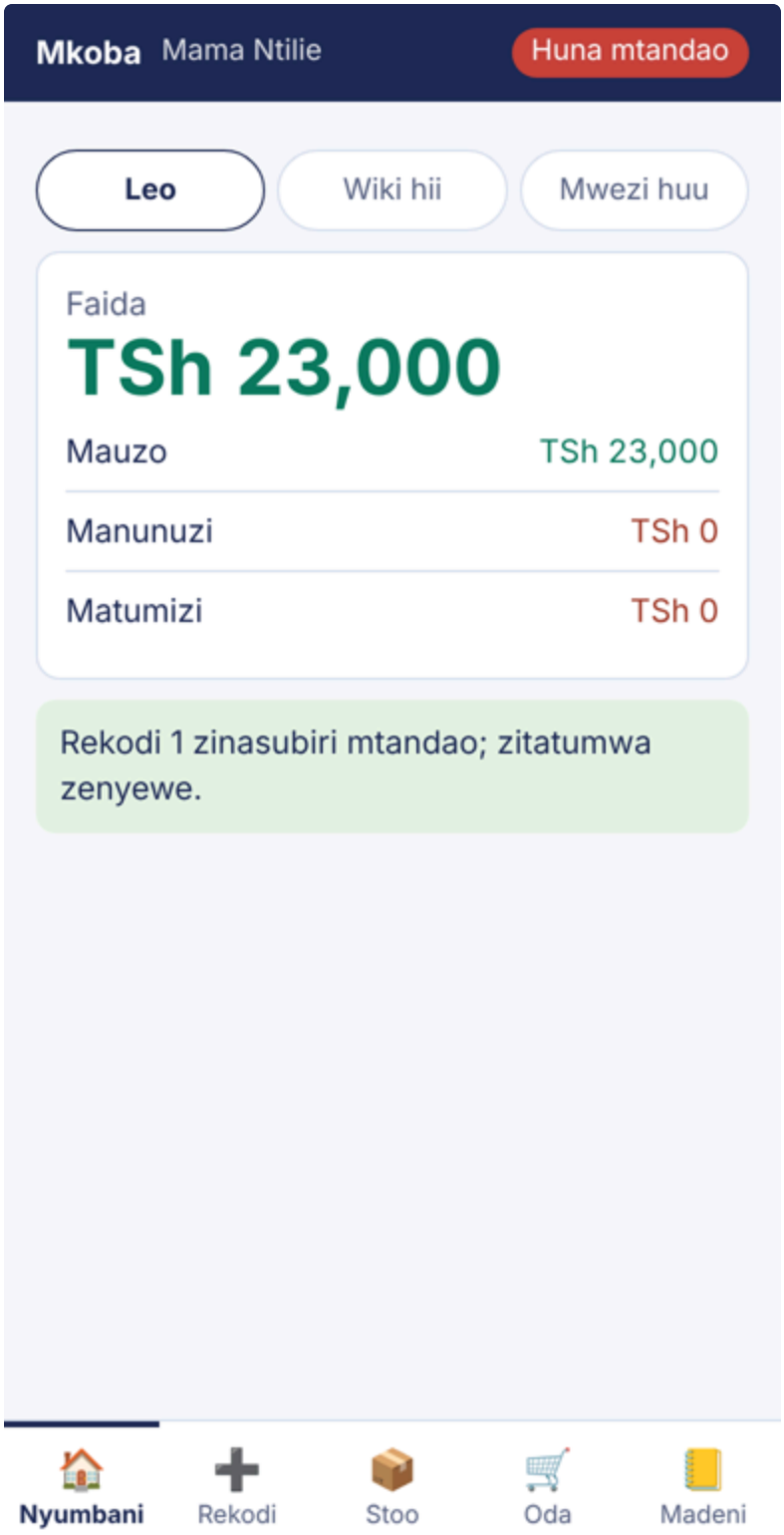
- **Nyumbani** (home): profit or loss for Leo, Wiki hii or Mwezi huu, with sales, purchases and expenses.

- **Rekodi** (records): choose Mauzo, Manunuzi or Matumizi; type the item, an optional quantity and unit, and the amount; tap **Hifadhi**. Below are your 30 latest records, each with **Futa** (delete) after a confirmation.
- **Stoo** (stock): your stock with low-stock warnings, and a form to set the amount you have.
- **Oda** (orders): order cards with **Kubali**, **Kataa** and **Imekamilika** buttons, which work exactly like the WhatsApp commands.
- **Madeni** (debts): who owes you and whom you owe, and a form to add a debt (choose the type: *Ninamdai*, *Ananidai*, *Amenilipa*, *Nimemlipa*).


Mkoba Mama Ntilie
Imehifadhiwa: Mauzo ya chips (3 pcs) TSh 4,500
Mauzo
Manunuzi
Matumizi
Bidhaa / kitu (si lazima)
Idadi (si lazima)
Kipimo
vipande
Kiasi (TSh)
Hifadhi
Rekodi za karibuni
Mauzo ya chips (3 pcs)
23/10 12:10
TSh 4,500 Futa
Deni la Juma (anadaiwa)
TSh 2,000 Futa
Nyumbani
Rekodi
Stoo
Oda
Madeni


Mkoba Mama Ntilie
Oda
#4 0712000333
imekubaliwa · imelipwa
chips x2
TSh 6,000
TSh 6,000
location aliyotuma (ramani)
0712000333 · 23/10 11:51
Imekamilika
#3 0712000222
imekubaliwa
chips x2
TSh 6,000
TSh 6,000
location aliyotuma (ramani)
0712000222 · 23/10 11:43
Imekamilika
#2 Juma
mpya
chips x3
TSh 9,000
soda x2
TSh 1,200
Nyumbani
Rekodi
Stoo
Oda
Madeni

32.3 Working offline



- After the first visit, the app opens without internet and shows the last data it loaded. A red **Huna mtandao** (offline) label appears at the top.

- Records saved offline wait on the phone (`Rekodi 1 zinasubiri mtandao; zitatumwa zenyewe.`) and are sent automatically when the connection returns. They keep the time you typed them (up to 7 days back).
- A record is never saved twice, even if sending is retried.
- Orders, stock counts and debts need a connection.

The app is in Swahili or English, following your Mkoba language.

33. Administrator guide for version 2.0

This adds to chapter 15.

33.1 New admin pages

All are linked from `https://mkoba.digital/admin` and use the same password. Forms only work when sent from the admin page itself.

Page	What you do there
`/admin/bulk`	Add collection points (name, area, optional latitude and longitude) and switch them off/on; add wholesale products (name as vendors write it, unit, price per unit) and remove them; see each group order's totals per item, value, and per-member breakdown with delivery choice; press **Goods arrived** for a closed order
`/admin/lenders`	Add a lender (code such as NMB, name, contact). The password is shown **once**: give it to the lender privately. **New password** and **Switch off** log the lender out at once
`/admin/riders`	Approve riders who applied, add riders directly, switch them off; set the delivery fee (base, per km, road factor, minimum, rounding, alert distance); see the last 50 deliveries

Page	What you do there
`/admin/payments`	Money received and waiting; what is owed to each vendor (customer orders) and rider (delivery fees for delivered jobs); bulk money for suppliers; the last 60 payments. After paying a vendor or rider, click **Mark … sent**

The main admin page now also counts households separately.

33.2 New settings (.env)

Setting	Purpose
`WHATSAPP_DISPLAY_NUMBER`	Mkoba's WhatsApp number in shop links (default 255788001168)
`SELCOM_VENDOR`, `SELCOM_API_KEY`, `SELCOM_API_SECRET`	Selcom credentials. Empty = no payment links are sent
`SELCOM_LIVE`	`1` for live, anything else uses Selcom's test system
`SELCOM_BUYER_EMAIL`	Email sent to Selcom for every payment (Selcom requires one)
`SELCOM_EXPIRY_MINUTES`	How long a Selcom payment page stays open (default 60)
`GOOGLE_STT_CREDENTIALS`	Path to a Google service-account JSON file for voice notes (recommended)
`GOOGLE_STT_API_KEY`	Alternative to the service account
`USSD_TOKEN`	Secret part of the USSD callback address

All are listed at the end of `.env.example`. Reload the app after changing them.

33.3 Addresses to give to outside services

- **Selcom** payment notifications: `https://mkoba.digital/pay/selcom/webhook`
- **Africa's Talking** USSD callback: `https://mkoba.digital/ussd/<USSD_TOKEN>` (a wrong secret returns "Not Found")

- **Lenders** portal: `https://mkoba.digital/l`

33.4 What the 21:00 evening run now does

After the evening reports (chapter 6), the same run:

1. Closes weekly group orders that are due (Friday) and sends members their shares and payment links.
2. Saves a daily score for vendors who allowed a lender.
3. Re-checks payments still waiting after 3 minutes with Selcom, and expires payments older than 7 days.

The log shows a line for each: `Bulk orders:`, `Score snapshots:`, `Payments checked:`.

33.5 Setup checklist before going live

1. Deploy version 2.0. Database changes 009–018 are applied by the deploy (`node migrate.js`).
2. `/admin/bulk`: add collection points (with map positions) and wholesale prices.
3. `/admin/riders`: add or approve riders; check the fee settings.
4. `/admin/lenders`: add lenders and give them their passwords.
5. Selcom: get the vendor ID, API key and secret (info@selcom.net), fill the settings with `SELCOM_LIVE=0`, give Selcom the notification address, test a payment, then set `SELCOM_LIVE=1`.
6. Google Cloud: switch on Speech-to-Text, create a service account, copy its key file to the server (readable only by the `mkoba` user, never committed to GitHub), set `GOOGLE_STT_CREDENTIALS`.
7. Africa's Talking: create a USSD channel, set `USSD_TOKEN`, set the callback address, test in their simulator, then apply for the real shortcode.

33.6 Version 2.0 troubleshooting

Symptom	Check	Fix
No payment links sent	`/admin/payments` says "Selcom is not set up"	Fill the three Selcom settings and reload

Symptom	Check	Fix
Payments stay "pending"	Selcom notification address; logs for `selcom_failed`	Give Selcom the address; pending payments are re-checked each evening
Voice notes get "please type"	`GOOGLE_STT_CREDENTIALS` or `GOOGLE_STT_API_KEY` set? Logs for `voice_failed`	Check the key file path, that Speech-to-Text is on, and billing
USSD says "Not Found"	The secret in the callback address	Make it match `USSD_TOKEN` exactly
Delivery fee is "to be agreed"	Vendor or collection point has no map position, or the customer did not share a location	Ask the vendor to share location; add latitude/longitude to the point
Group order did not close	`journalctl -u mkoba-reports` for `Bulk orders:`	It closes in the first 21:00 run after Friday 20:00

Appendix A. Feature coverage matrix

Every user-facing feature found in the source code, where it is documented, and how it was verified. **Code** = behaviour read in the source. **Run** = exercised on a demonstration copy of the app (real code, demo database, WhatsApp sending in dry-run). **Shot** = screenshot taken from that copy. **Tests** = covered by the 183 automated tests, all passing.

#	Feature	Source file	Manual section	Verified by
1	Welcome and consent gate	privacy.js, webhook.js	2, 11.2	Code, Run, Tests
2	Sign-up: name and business type, `ruka`	onboarding.js	2	Code, Run, Tests
3	Record sale / purchase / expense	parser.js, ledger.js	4.1–4.3	Code, Run, Tests
4	Amount formats, Swahili number words, slang	parser.js	4.4	Code, Tests
5	Quantities and units	parser.js	4.5	Code, Tests

#	Feature	Source file	Manual section	Verified by
6	Several records in one message	parser.js, ledger.js	4.6	Code, Run, Tests
7	Verb typo correction	parser.js	4.3	Code, Tests
8	Price memory and "bei gani?"	ledger.js	4.7	Code, Run, Tests
9	Confidence: save / confirm / not understood	ledger.js	4.8, 5.1	Code, Run, Tests
10	Non-text message hints	webhook.js	4.9	Code, Run
11	NDIO / HAPANA confirmation (1 hour)	ledger.js	5.1	Code, Run, Tests
12	`futa` (delete last)	corrections.js	5.2	Code, Run, Tests
13	`rekebisha` (correct last amount)	corrections.js	5.3	Code, Run, Tests
14	Summaries leo/jana/wiki/mwezi/salio	summary.js	6.1, 6.2	Code, Run, Tests
15	Summary insights (best seller, biggest cost, previous period)	summary.js	6.2	Code, Run, Tests
16	Evening report, Sunday weekly, template fallback	reports.js	6.3	Code, Run (dry-run), Tests
17	ACHA / ANZA RIPOTI	reports.js	6.4	Code, Run, Tests
18	Debt recording, four directions	debts.js	7.1–7.4	Code, Run, Tests
19	Debt list with age; one-person balance	debts.js	7.5	Code, Run, Tests
20	Forwardable debt reminder	debts.js	7.6	Code, Run, Tests

#	Feature	Source file	Manual section	Verified by
21	Airtel Money SMS: merchant, till, bundle	mobilemoney.js	8.2	Code, Run, Tests
22	Airtel Money SMS: person transfer 1/2/3	mobilemoney.js	8.3	Code, Run, Tests
23	SMS recognised but not saved (own transfer, card, Ksh)	mobilemoney.js	8.4	Code, Run, Tests
24	Duplicate SMS protection	mobilemoney.js	8.5	Code, Run, Tests
25	Dashboard one-time link and login	dashboard.js	9.1	Code, Run, Shot
26	Dashboard 30-day session, logout	dashboard.js	9.2, 9.4	Code, Run, Shot
27	Dashboard periods, chart, recent records, debts	dashboard.js	3.2, 9.3	Code, Run, Shot
28	Business statement link (30 days), sw/en	statement.js	10.1–10.3	Code, Run, Shot
29	Close statement; newer link closes older	statement.js	10.4	Code, Run, Shot
30	Language switch, automatic detection	i18n.js, webhook.js	11.1	Code, Run, Tests
31	Privacy pages /faragha and /privacy	privacy-page.js	11.3	Code, Shot
32	Delete all data (FUTA DATA, FUTA KABISA)	privacy.js	11.4	Code, Run, Tests
33	Help list (`msaada`)	i18n.js, summary.js	20.1	Code, Run
34	System error reply	webhook.js	14	Code
35	Admin page	admin.js	15.1	Code, Run, Shot

#	Feature	Source file	Manual section	Verified by
36	Parser feedback and review tool	feedback.js, review.js	15.2, 20.3	Code
37	Health check	app.js, whatsapp.js	15.4	Code, Run
38	Deploy pipeline and migrations	deploy.yml, migrate.js	15.5	Code

Version 2.0 features. Sim = run on the demonstration copy with the outside service simulated (no real call to Selcom, Google, Meta or Africa's Talking). **Browser** = tested in a real browser at phone size.

#	Feature	Source file	Manual section	Verified by
39	Stock counted from records; counts entered by vendor	stock.js	21.1–21.2	Code, Run, Tests
40	Stock list with days left; low-stock alerts (automatic and own level); out-of-stock notice	stock.js	21.3–21.4	Code, Run, Tests
41	Low stock in evening report and dashboard	reports.js, dashboard.js	21.4	Code, Run
42	Customer receipts, numbering, stock update	loyalty.js	22.1	Code, Run, Tests
43	Points (earn, follow futa/rekebisha), balances, use points	loyalty.js	22.2–22.3	Code, Run, Tests
44	Product catalog commands and shop code	catalog.js	23.1	Code, Run, Tests
45	Customer ordering on WhatsApp (cart, delivery or pickup, location)	catalog.js, webhook.js	23.2	Code, Run, Tests

#	Feature	Source file	Manual section	Verified by
46	Customer ordering on the web page	catalog.js	23.3	Code, Run
47	Order accept / reject / complete (sale, points, receipt)	catalog.js	23.4	Code, Run, Tests
48	Waiting-order notice outside the 24-hour window; past-customer hint	catalog.js, webhook.js	23.2, 23.5	Code, Run
49	Groups: list, join by code/name/area/location, create, leave	bulk.js	24.1	Code, Run, Tests
50	Weekly group order, prices, purchase suggestions	bulk.js	24.2–24.3	Code, Run, Tests
51	Order closing, member notices, goods received as purchases	bulk.js	24.4–24.5	Code, Run
52	Household sign-up and restricted commands	household.js	25.1, 25.3	Code, Run, Tests
53	Delivery choice per member (home / place / point)	bulk.js	25.2	Code, Run, Tests
54	Credit score: calculation, minimum data, tips	score.js	26	Code, Run (hand-checked), Tests
55	Score on statement and dashboard; daily snapshots	statement.js, dashboard.js, lender.js	26.1, 26.3	Code, Run
56	Vendor permissions for lenders (allow, decline, revoke, list)	lender.js	27.1	Code, Run, Tests
57	Lender portal: login, request access, vendor page, logs	lender.js	27.2	Code, Run, Tests
58	Delivery jobs from orders and bulk shares; distance fee	delivery.js	28.1–28.2	Code, Run, Tests

#	Feature	Source file	Manual section	Verified by
59	Delivery status notices	delivery.js	28.3	Code, Run
60	Rider sign-up, approval, job commands	delivery.js	28.4	Code, Run, Tests
61	Selcom request signing	selcom.js	29	Code, Tests (no live call)
62	Payment links, LIPA PIN prompt, status check, notices	payments.js	29.1–29.2	Code, Sim
63	Payouts owed and recorded	payments.js	29.3, 33.1	Code, Sim
64	Voice notes: download, length check, transcription, NDIO for records	voice.js, webhook.js	30	Code, Sim, Tests
65	Spoken quantities ("kilo tano")	parser.js	30.1	Code, Tests
66	USSD registration and menu	ussd.js	31	Code, Sim, Tests
67	Lite App: login, five tabs, order actions	liteapp.js, public/app	32.1–32.2	Code, Browser
68	Lite App offline use and duplicate-safe sending	public/app, liteapp.js	32.3	Browser
69	Admin pages: bulk, lenders, riders, payments	bulk.js, lender.js, delivery.js, payments.js	33.1	Code, Run
70	Evening run: bulk closing, score snapshots, payment checks	reports.js	33.4	Code, Run

No user-facing feature in the source code is left undocumented.

Appendix B. Known limitations and unresolved questions

B.1 Known limitations (current behaviour)

#	Limitation	Effect on users
1	Photos of receipts are not read; voice notes need Google set up and are limited to 1 minute	Long or photo records must be typed
2	Records are dated when received; no back-dating (except Lite App records typed offline)	Late entries count on the wrong day
3	On WhatsApp only the last message can be corrected or deleted (the Lite App can delete any of the 30 latest)	Older mistakes need the app or the administrator
4	`rekebisha` changes the amount only	Kind or item mistakes need `futa` and re-sending
5	Mobile-money SMS: Airtel Money Tanzania, money out only	Received payments and other providers must be typed
6	Debt names: one word or title + word	Debts can split across names
7	`nimelipa <name>` is an expense, not a debt repayment	Must use `nimemlipa`
8	A record waiting for NDIO is dropped if another record is sent first	Vendor must re-send
9	Dashboard pages, the web shop and lender portal language are fixed (Swahili; portal English)	Some users see the other language
10	The short evening report after 23 hours of silence is Swahili only, without insights	Less detail for inactive vendors
11	No full record list or spreadsheet export	Only totals and the 30 latest records
12	Name and business type cannot be changed by the vendor	Needs the administrator

#	Limitation	Effect on users
13	One account per WhatsApp number; records cannot move to a new number	Changing number starts over
14	TSh only	Other currencies rejected
15	Evening report time is fixed at 21:00; bulk orders close Friday 20:00	Cannot be personalised
16	Statement and score are self-reported and unverified	Lenders must judge reliability
17	Mkoba cannot message customers, riders or vendors who have not written in 24 hours (no approved templates except evening reports)	Vendors forward receipts and reminders; waiting items arrive with the next message
18	Payouts to vendors and riders are sent by the administrator by hand	Settlement takes admin work
19	Bulk items must use the same names as the wholesale list (e.g. `mchele`, not `rice`)	Unmatched items have no price
20	Delivery fees need map positions on both sides; web orders cannot share a location	Some fees are "to be agreed"
21	Customers have no `FUTA DATA` of their own	Their order data is deleted only with the vendor's data
22	USSD covers recording, summaries, debts, stock and delete only	Other features need WhatsApp or the app
23	Admin summary boxes wrap awkwardly on wide screens	Cosmetic only

B.2 Features deliberately not built

- An AI fallback for unclear messages (item 22 of the first improvement list): skipped by the product owner.
- Off-site backup copies (part of item 27): skipped; backups are kept on the same server for 14 days.

- Voice notes, skipped in version 1.0, were added in version 2.0 (chapter 30).
- Automatic payouts through Selcom: not built; payouts are recorded by hand (29.3).

B.3 Unresolved questions

#	Question	Owner
1	What support contact should vendors use (20.2)? `PRIVACY_CONTACT` must also be set for the privacy page.	Product owner
2	What data location should the privacy page state (`DATA_LOCATION`)?	Product owner
3	When will incoming Airtel Money SMS be supported? Needs real sample messages.	Product owner
4	Has version 2.0 (migrations 008–018) been deployed to production?	Administrator
5	Tanzania PDPA 2022: registration with the PDPC, any permit for storing data outside Tanzania, and agreements with processors now used (Selcom, Google, Africa's Talking).	Product owner, legal
6	Pricing, if any, to state in the FAQ.	Product owner
7	Selcom: confirm the payment status words, the buyer-email requirement and whether the PIN prompt works for all wallets (M-Pesa, Airtel, Mixx by Yas, HaloPesa).	Administrator, Selcom
8	Google Speech-to-Text: confirm Swahili accuracy on real voice notes and the cost per month.	Product owner
9	USSD shortcode from Africa's Talking and TCRA.	Product owner
10	Fee defaults (TSh 1,000 + 750/km × 1.3) agreed with riders.	Product owner
11	Meta-approved templates so Mkoba can message customers and riders outside the 24-hour window.	Product owner

Appendix C. Manual validation report

C.1 Method

1. **Source review.** Every module of the application was read: parser, ledger, corrections, summaries, reports, debts, mobile money, onboarding, privacy, dashboard, statement, admin, language strings and the web server. Command words, limits (1 hour, 10 minutes, 15 minutes, 30 days, 21:00, 23 hours, 100, 12 records, 14 days, 6 months) and reply texts in this manual were copied from the code.
2. **Running the real application.** A copy of the current code was run against a separate demonstration database with fictional vendors ("Asha Demo", "John Demo"). WhatsApp messages were simulated as signed webhook calls, and replies captured with sending in dry-run mode. No production data was read or changed, and no message was sent to a real person.
3. **Example checks.** Parser examples in chapters 4 and 7 were run through the parser and the results compared with the text (for example `nimelipa Juma 2000` → expense; `Juma Ali anadaiwa 4000` → saved under "Ali").
4. **Screenshots.** All 11 screenshots were taken from the running demonstration copy, at phone and computer widths. None is a mock-up. They contain only fictional data.
5. **Automated tests.** The project's test suite was run: 183 of 183 passed.

C.2 Results

Check	Result
Features in code that are documented	38 of 38 (Appendix A)
Features in the manual that do not exist in code	None
Reply texts quoted	Copied from `i18n.js`; examples confirmed in the demo run
Corrections made while writing	3: a pending-reply example was reordered to match the real format; a debt-name rule was changed from "not supported" to the real behaviour (saved under the last word); a parsing reason that cannot occur was removed

Check	Result
Secrets or private data in the manual	None. Settings are listed by name only; phone numbers and names in examples are fictional

C.3 Not verified in this run

- **Real WhatsApp delivery:** replies were checked in dry-run mode, not on a phone. Their exact appearance in the WhatsApp app was not captured.
- **The approved report template's exact wording** is stored at Meta, not in the code; 6.3 describes its contents only.
- **Production server commands** in 15.4–15.5 (PM2, systemd, nginx) reflect the configuration set up earlier in this project and were not re-run for this manual.
- **Production deployment of the latest features** (Appendix B.3, question 4).

C.4 Version 2.0 validation (23 October 2026)

1. **Source review.** Every new module was read while writing chapters 21–33: stock, loyalty, catalog, bulk, household, score, lender, delivery, selcom, payments, voice, ussd and the Lite App. Command words, limits and reply texts were copied from the code.
2. **Demonstration runs.** Each feature was exercised end to end on the demonstration copy: stock counts and alerts; receipts and points; a WhatsApp shop order through acceptance, delivery, payment and completion; a web order; a weekly group order with two vendors and two households, closing and arrival; scores for three made-up vendors (one checked by hand: 87/100); a lender request, permission, view and removal; rider sign-up, approval and a delivery; payment links, PIN prompt and payout records; voice notes; USSD sessions.
3. **Simulated outside services.** Selcom, Google Speech-to-Text and Africa's Talking were simulated; none was called for real. Their request formats come from Selcom's developer page and an open-source Selcom integration, Google's documentation, and an Africa's Talking USSD example. These must be tested with real accounts before going live (B.3).
4. **Lite App.** Tested in a real browser at phone size: login screen, all five tabs, saving online, saving offline and automatic sending when back online (each record arrived once), and refusal of requests from other sites. The four screenshots in chapter 32 come from this test.
5. **Automated tests.** 299 of 299 passed.

6. **Corrections made in this version of the manual.** Statements that were no longer true were updated: Mkoba now handles voice notes (1.6, 4.9, FAQ), the Lite App can change records (3.2, 13.2, 13.3), and the limitations list (B.1) was rewritten.

Appendix D. Version history

Version	Date	Changes
1.0	22 October 2026	First complete manual: vendor guide (chapters 1–14), administrator guide (15), troubleshooting, FAQ, glossary, quick reference, support, coverage matrix, limitations and validation report. Covers the application including migration 008 (business statement).
2.0	23 October 2026	Part II (chapters 21–33): stock, receipts and points, shop catalog and orders, Jirani Bulk Buy, household group buys, credit score, lenders and lender portal, boda delivery, Selcom payments, voice notes, USSD, the Lite App, and the version 2.0 administrator guide. Updated chapters 1, 2, 3, 4.9, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 19 and Appendices A–D. Covers migrations 009–018.